

Men's Fitness
GUIDE

WORKOUT MANUAL

**Your complete guide to building
muscle and burning fat**



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- ✓ **Created by experts**
- ✓ **Healthy diet advice**

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WORKOUT MANUAL

welcome

Now, more than ever, we all want to feel stronger, energised, and our healthiest, best selves.

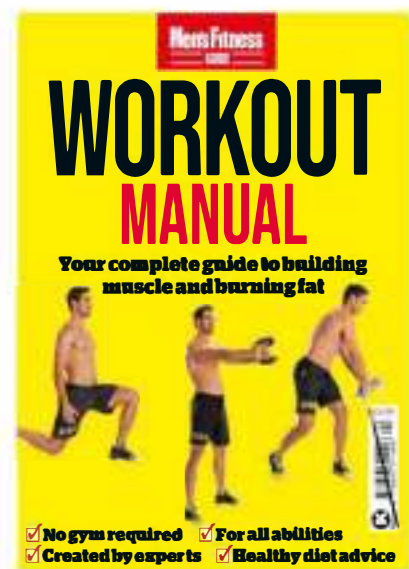
That's why this special bookazine from the editors of Men's Fitness will arguably be the most important item in your fitness kit. It includes all you need to know to get you looking toned and feeling great, whatever fitness level you're at.

With advice from top fitness experts, *The Workout Manual* includes targeted workouts for

fat loss (p8), the most effective bodyweight training moves for when you can't use traditional weights (p37), plus strength and power building circuits (p47).

And of course, you can't shred fat and build muscle with exercise alone, so be sure to read the Nutrition 101 (p63) to ensure your diet is on track.

So what are you waiting for? Check out the safety and other need-to-know advice from p5 and get to work on your best body yet.



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contents



5 Introduction

Make the most of your workouts with tips and tricks from leading trainers, sort fitness fact from fiction, and ensure you exercise safely.

8 Lose fat

No-nonsense, quickfire routines that will burn hundreds of calories and get your body lean as fast as possible.

18 Build muscle

Want to pack on mass, get stronger and be the proud owner of an impressive six-pack? These straightforward, effective workouts hold the key.

37 Balance your body

Set the weights aside and discover the power of your own bodyweight with these targeted moves.

47 Home workouts

You don't need to pay out for the gym to get in shape - check out these workouts to build the body you want without leaving your living room!

63 Nutrition

The way you eat is as important as the way you train when you're trying to improve your fitness, so here are the guidelines to follow in the kitchen.

The truth about training

The no-nonsense facts behind the most common fitness myths

1 'THE MORE YOU TRAIN, THE BETTER THE RESULTS'

You need to train hard and regularly, but doing too much too often is counterproductive. If you're new to working out, start with three sessions a week to give your muscles time to recover - and grow - before training them again. Too little rest between sessions can result in overtraining, when you feel tired, fatigued and demotivated. You're also more likely to suffer from injury.

2 'YOU CAN TURN FAT INTO MUSCLE'

Fat and muscle are two totally different types of tissue, so it's impossible for one to turn into the other. Muscle is active tissue that burns calories, while fat tissues store excess energy. When you train hard, it's possible to burn fat and build muscle at the same time, giving the appearance that one has turned into the other, but this isn't actually the case.

3 'MACHINES ARE BETTER THAN FREE WEIGHTS'

Resistance machines have their place in a gym: they are a great way for beginners to learn movement patterns without the risk of danger, and they allow experienced trainees to isolate specific muscles to lift heavier weights. But because the movement pattern is so restricted, they're no good at working the stabilising muscles that are so important in staying injury-free. Free weights such as dumbbells and barbells require more skill to use, recruit these smaller stabilising muscles and allow you to move through a greater range of motion to work your muscles to their full extent.

4 'CARDIO TRAINING IS BEST FOR FAT LOSS'

High-intensity cardio, such as sprints or hill runs, is great for fat loss. However long and slow steady-state sessions, while good for aerobic conditioning

and heart health, aren't very efficient for burning fat. This is because long sessions increase the levels of the stress hormone cortisol in your body, which actually encourages it to store more fat. Weight training is more effective than cardio for burning fat as well as building muscle, and should form the core of your training programme.

5 'DOING SIT-UPS WILL BURN BELLY FAT'

You can't lose fat from a specific part of your body. No matter how many crunches or similar abs exercises you do, they won't shift your belly. More often than not, the fat on your stomach is the last to go, so you need a thorough and well-structured training and nutrition plan to chip away constantly at your body fat percentage.

6 'WEIGHT TRAINING MAKES YOU TOO BULKY'

Putting on serious amounts of lean muscle mass takes time, and only then if you have a progressive training plan and eat the right foods at the right time. No one has ever woken up after a great chest and arms workout to discover that none of their T-shirts fit.

"Weight training is more effective than cardio for burning fat as well as building muscle, and should form the core of your training programme"

Master the gym

Gyms can seem like unfriendly and intimidating places, especially if you're not used to them, but increase your comfort level and you'll find everything much easier and enjoyable. Here's how it's done...



Learn to 'work in'

This is gym code for sharing the equipment. Generally, the wrong thing to do is shuffle around someone using equipment, looking as though you want it but not saying anything. If the kit you need is in use, wait until the person has finished their set. No-one wants to chat mid-squat! Wait until their rest, then politely ask if you can 'work in' (use the equipment while they're resting). Most people will be fine with it. And it goes without saying that if someone asks, you should share your kit with them too.

Get a spotter

To make the most of your sessions, you'll occasionally need a spotter - someone to make sure you're safe under the weight and help you out with your last few reps if needed. Most gym-goers will be more than happy to oblige if you ask politely. Communication with your spotter is key, though. Let

them know how many reps you're aiming for, when they should touch the weights (ideally as little as possible) and how much help they should give you. And always be prepared to return the favour.

Brainstorm your back-ups

Before you hit the gym, think about what you'll do if the kit you need is unavailable. As you get more comfortable with working out you'll be able to figure this out on the go, but in the early stages it's best to plan ahead and work out some alternative moves in case it's busy.

Leave it as you'd like to find it

This may sound obvious, but you should always return any equipment to its place after using it. If you're strong enough to lift it, you're strong enough to put it back! Another gym etiquette must: always wipe your sweat off the machines, mats and benches.

Safety first



Reduce your injury risk at the gym with this trio of simple tips

1 IF YOU FEEL PAIN AT ANY TIME DURING YOUR WORKOUT, STOP IMMEDIATELY

Don't be tempted to work through the pain or you could make a small problem significantly worse.

2 MAINTAIN PERFECT FORM FOR EVERY REPETITION, OR REP, OF EVERY EXERCISE

Each exercise in this book comes with detailed notes on form and most gyms have qualified fitness professionals on hand who will be happy to help if you're unsure about an exercise.

3 PICK A WEIGHT YOU CAN MANAGE EASILY THE FIRST TIME YOU DO A LIFT

This allows you to concentrate on perfecting the form - you can increase the weight over time. Leave your ego at the door. Choosing a weight that's too heavy is the fastest way to cut your training short through injury.



Fat loss workouts

Blast flab with these simple one-kit workouts

Training sessions don't have to be lengthy and complicated to be effective. For optimum fat loss, you can simply grab a single bit of equipment and do one of these quickfire routines. Every workout in this chapter is a "complex" – a workout format that's ironically very straightforward. You just pick up a piece of kit and don't let go until you've performed every rep of every exercise, which is great for ramping up your metabolism to burn more calories, not to mention building an iron grip.

Terminology decoded

REPS

An abbreviation of repetitions. One rep is the completion of a given exercise from start to finish through a full range of motion.

SETS

A given number of reps of a single exercise performed consecutively without rest.

REST

The time you take between exercises and/or sets, during which your muscles and lungs are given the chance to recover.

CONTENTS

Double dumbbells	p9
Weight plates	p18
Kettlebells	p22

Double dumbbells

Recapture your six-pack with this simple six-move dumbbell complex



The coach

Shivam Patel

The plan

“Repeat this workout two to three times a week and use this plan to ensure progression,” says Patel.

Complexes are simple: grab a piece of kit and don't let go until you've torched hundreds of calories. With this dumbbell complex, you do each exercise for the required number of reps (see table, below), then move on to the next move without putting the dumbbells down - so choose your weight wisely.

Only rest after you finish all six exercises. Add this complex to the end of your workout for a fat-blasting finisher or on its own as a quick 15-minute session.

“The key to fat loss is building and preserving as

much muscle as possible,” says Patel. “That's because muscle tissue contributes to a higher resting metabolism, meaning you'll burn more fat at rest.

“Complexes are ideal because you stimulate multiple muscles and different energy systems at once, help release fat-burning hormones and create an oxygen deficit which increases the after-burn effect of your workout, so you keep burning fat for hours.”

So: grab a pair of dumbbells and make sure you've got a good grip - you'll need it!

WEEK 1

SETS **2** REPS **8** REST **90sec**

WEEK 2

SETS **3** REPS **8** REST **90sec**

WEEK 3

SETS **3** REPS **10** REST **90sec**

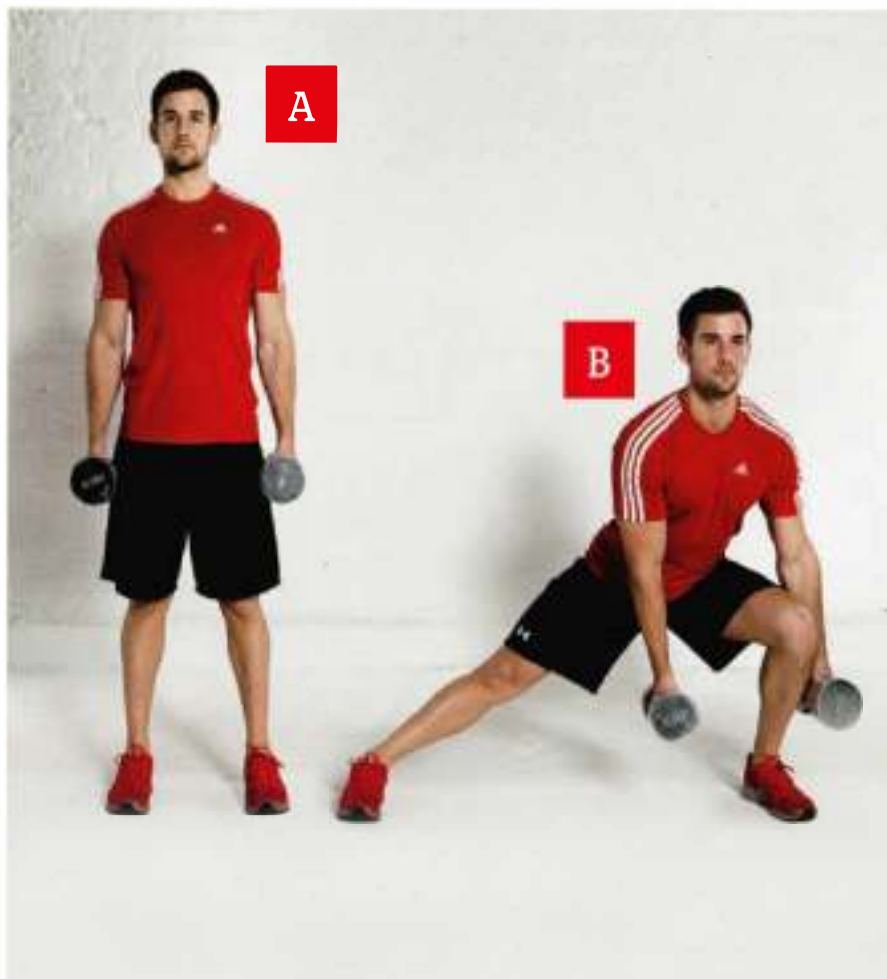
WEEK 4

SETS **3** REPS **10** REST **60sec**

1 SIDE LUNGE

Take a big step to one side and, keeping your chest up, lower into a side lunge so the dumbbells are on either side of your leading leg. Drive back up to the start and continue into a lunge on the other side.

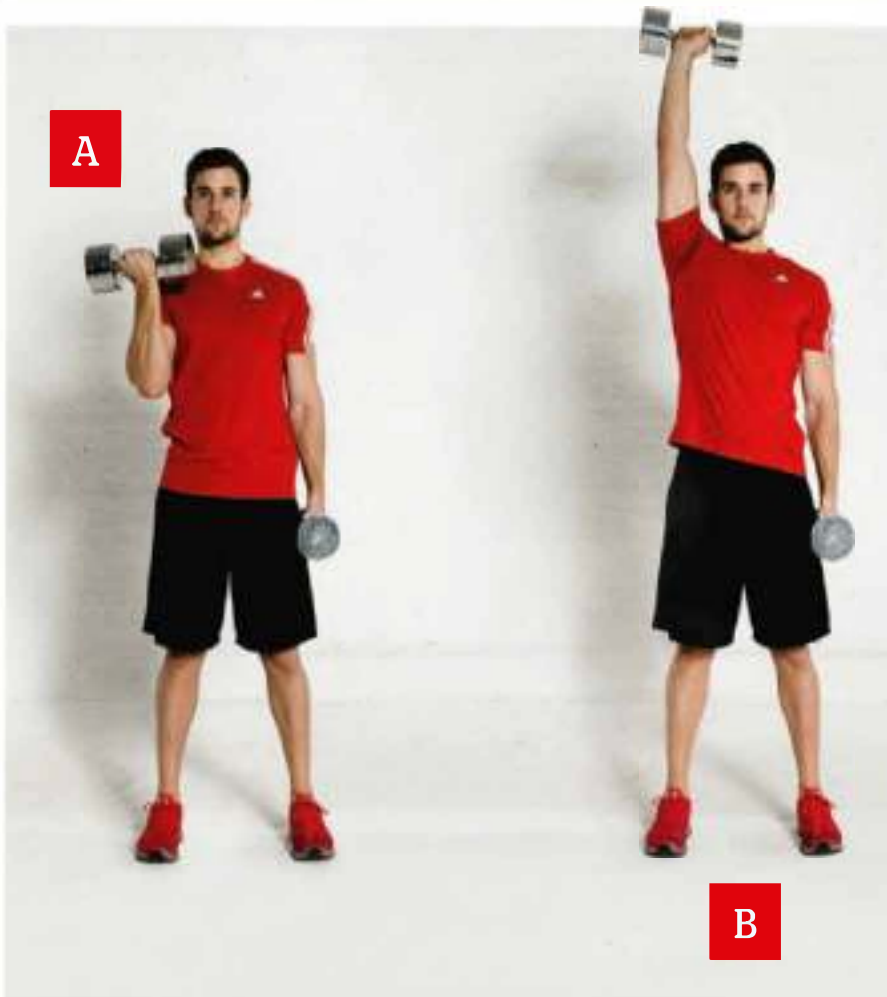
“Keep your abs tight throughout the move to keep your back straight and torso tall,” says Patel.



2 UNILATERAL CURL AND PRESS

Curl one dumbbell to chest height, then press it overhead before lowering. Repeat on the other side.

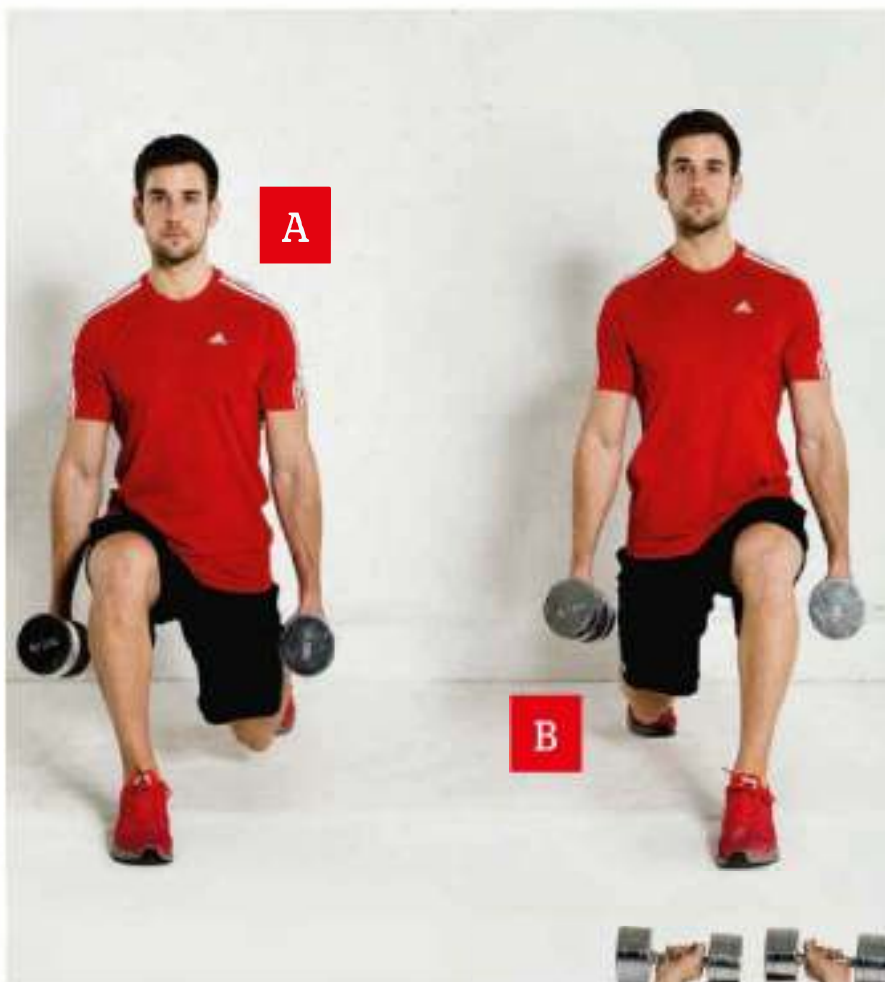
“Think of this more like a clean than a curl,” says Patel.
“Hinge forwards at the hips and drive them forwards to generate power to lift the weight.”



FORWARD LUNGE

Take a big step forwards into a lunge, keeping your knee in line with your toes. Do likewise on your other side.

“Take a big step to load your glutes and hamstrings or a shorter step to work your quads harder.”



4 THRUSTER

Bring the dumbbells up to shoulder height, with palms facing forwards and elbows high. Lower into a squat, then drive up powerfully, continuing to press the weights overhead.

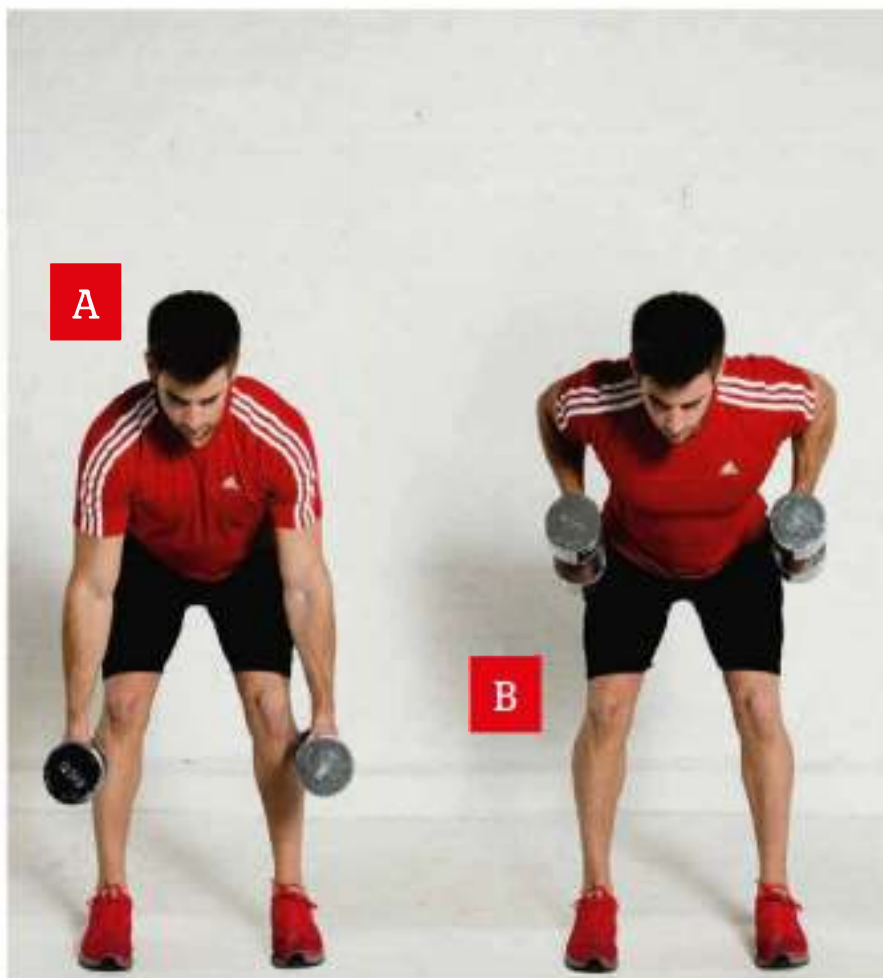
“Use your breathing to help keep your core strong. Inhale on the way down to fill your chest and only exhale at the top of the move.”



5 BENT-OVER ROW

Bend forwards - hingeing at the hips, not the waist - and row the dumbbells up towards your armpits.

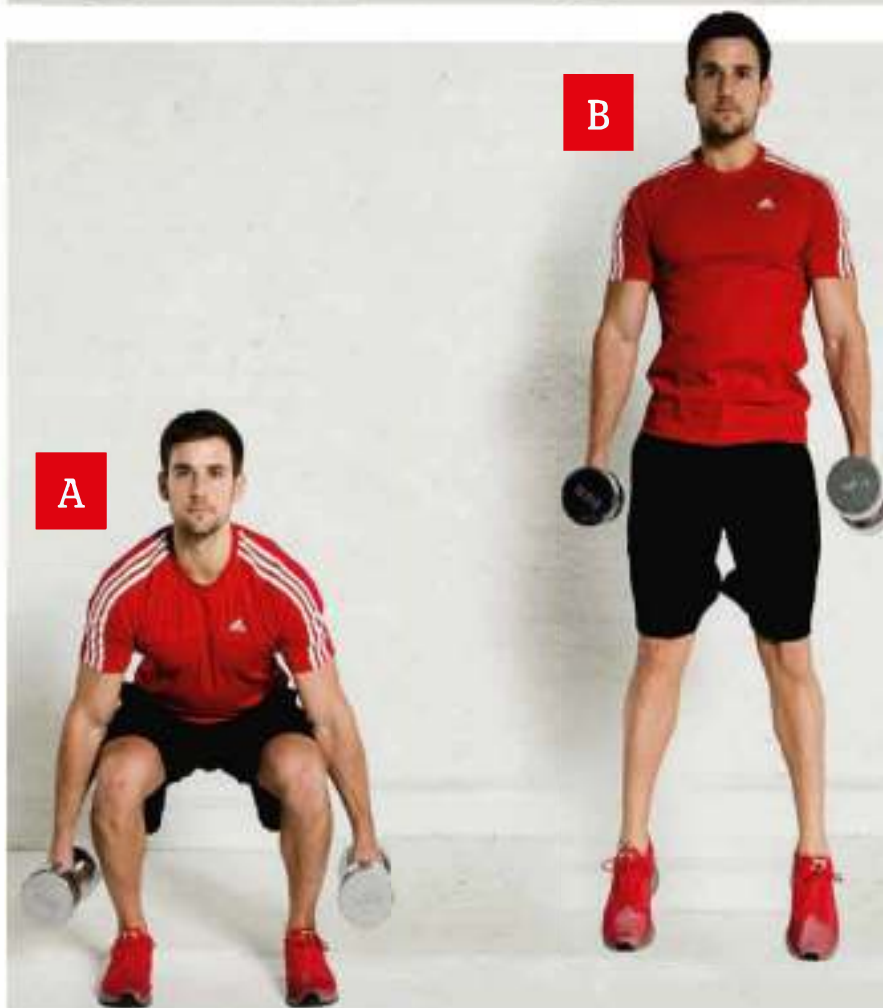
“Don’t break the alignment of your neck by looking up. Keep your chin tucked in and eyes on the floor.”



6 JUMP SQUAT

Holding the weights by your sides, lower into a quarter squat, then drive up powerfully and jump, bending your knees for a soft landing. Now you can let go of the dumbbells.

“Don’t rush - cushion each landing, rest at the bottom and generate power from the quarter squat position.”



7 CLEAN AND PRESS

Choose which arm is going to take the punishment first. Keep the weight in this hand for all six exercises before switching. Grab the dumbbell with legs bent and your eyes looking forwards

Drive up and pull the weight from the floor to chest height, then drop under it to “catch” it at shoulder height. Straighten your legs to stand and press the weight overhead.

Exhale during the clean, then inhale, then exhale again on the press to brace your core and stop lateral flexion of your spine,



8 REVERSE LUNGE

With the weight in the “catch” position at shoulder height, take a big step backwards with one foot. Brace your core to keep your balance and keep your torso upright, then lower until your knee is just off the floor. Drive back up to the start. Alternate legs.

“This is a great stretch for your hip flexors. Remember to engage your core first, then move to stop your pelvis rotating.”



Barbell

Combine these five full-body lifts into a super fat-fighting complex



The coach

Steve Kowalenko
of W10 Performance,
a former army PTL.

The plan

“Do this two or three times a week for four weeks using the same weight plan,” says Kowalenko. “Before you start, do an AMRAP test to see how many rounds you can do in ten minutes, then try again after four weeks. You should’ve smashed your initial max, as well as shedding plenty of fat.”

This complex unites five classic compound lifts to devastating fat-fighting effect. Grab a bar, do each exercise for the required number of reps (see the table, below), then move on to the next without setting the weight down. Only rest after you finish all five moves. Do this as a finisher

to a strength session or as a standalone quickfire workout.

“Barbell complexes are an effective tool to build muscle and at the same time fire up your metabolism to torch body fat,” says Kowalenko. “They’re fun, quick and elevate your metabolism for longer than

traditional cardio.

Also, while traditional cardio can increase your levels of cortisol, the stress hormone responsible for fat storage, this complex will release anabolic hormones that will outweigh its negative effects and help you maintain muscle mass.”

WEEK 1

SETS **3** REPS **6** REST **90sec**

WEEK 2

SETS **3** REPS **8** REST **90sec**

WEEK 3

SETS **3** REPS **10** REST **90sec**

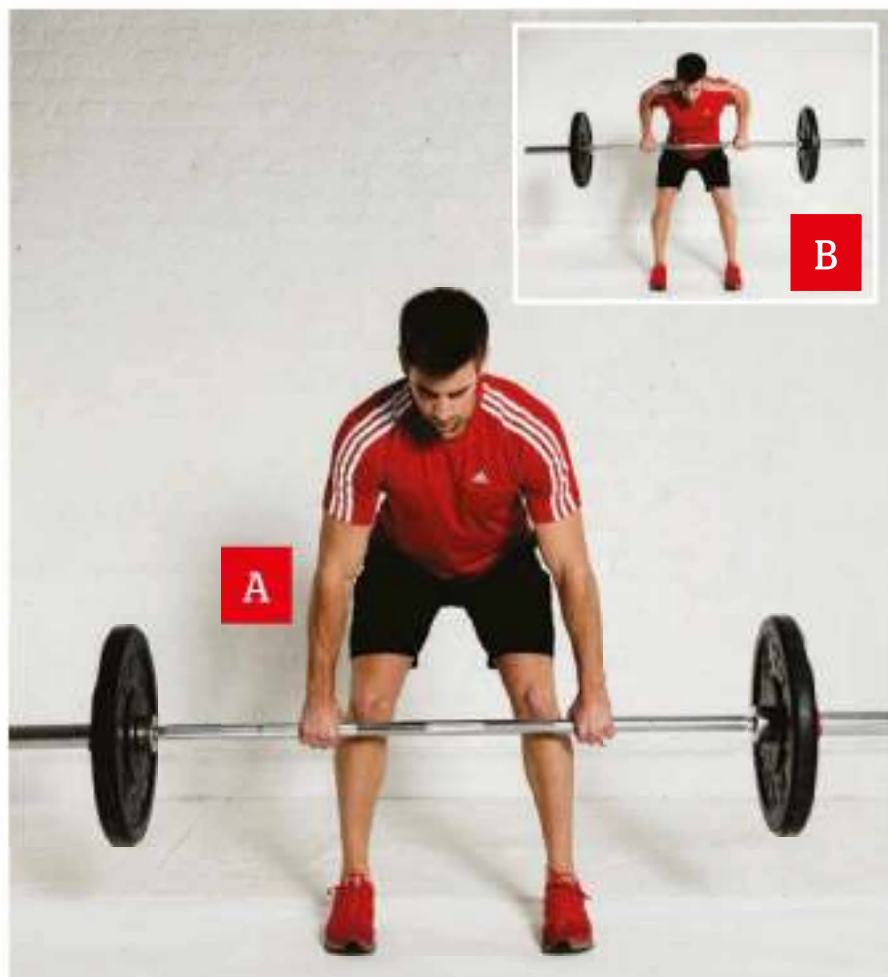
WEEK 4

SETS **4** REPS **10** REST **60sec**

1 BENT-OVER ROW

Hold the bar with an overhand grip, hands shoulder-width apart. Keep your core engaged and hinge forwards at your hips, keeping your back flat. Pull the bar up to your sternum, then lower.

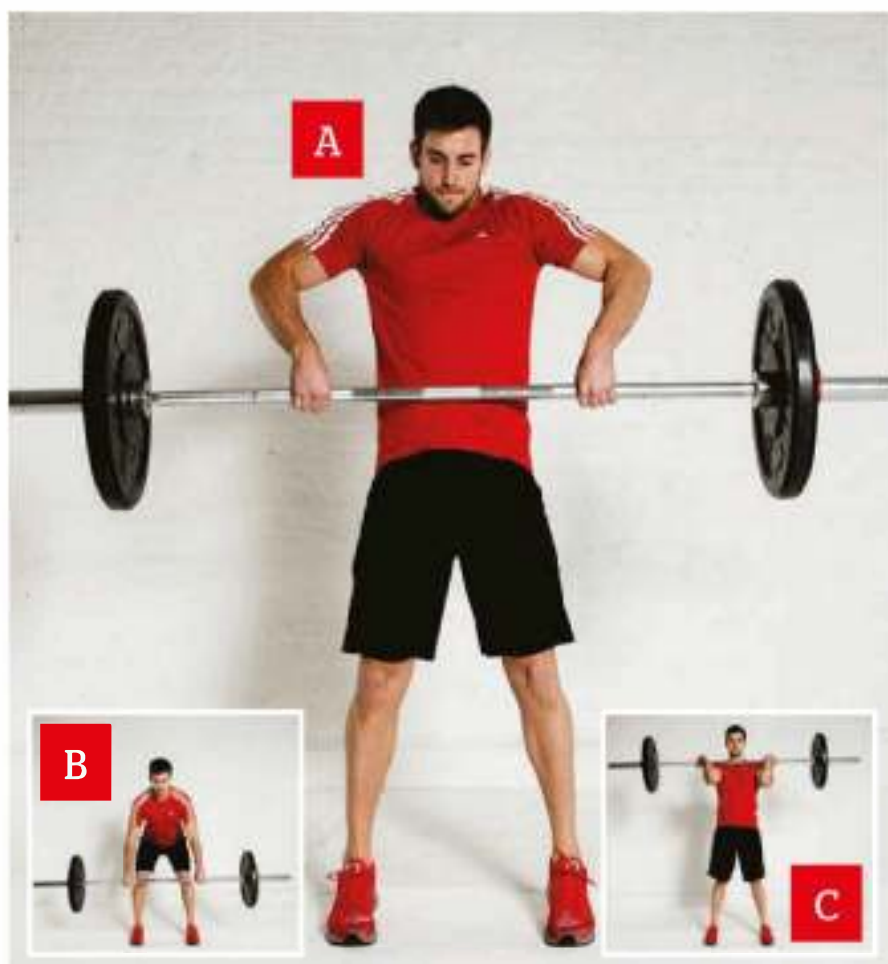
“Pull your elbows towards the ceiling rather than just pulling with your hands to recruit your upper back,” says Kowalenko.



2 HANG POWER CLEAN

Allow the bar to hang with straight arms so it's just above your knees. Straighten up and snap your hips forwards to help you lift the bar high and catch it on the top of your chest, with your elbows as high as you can get them.

“At the start, push your bum back so your hamstrings and glutes are fully engaged. Don't bend your knees.”



3 FRONT SQUAT

With the bar resting on the top of your chest and elbows high, squat until your thighs are at least parallel to the floor. Make sure your knees stay wide apart and heels remain in contact with the ground. Drive back up.

“Squat straight down. If your hips go backwards it will cause you to lean forwards and strain your back.”



4 PUSH PRESS

Get a good grip on the bar again. Drop into a quarter squat and, as you drive back up, use the momentum to press the bar overhead. Keep your core and glutes tight so your back doesn't curve under the weight.

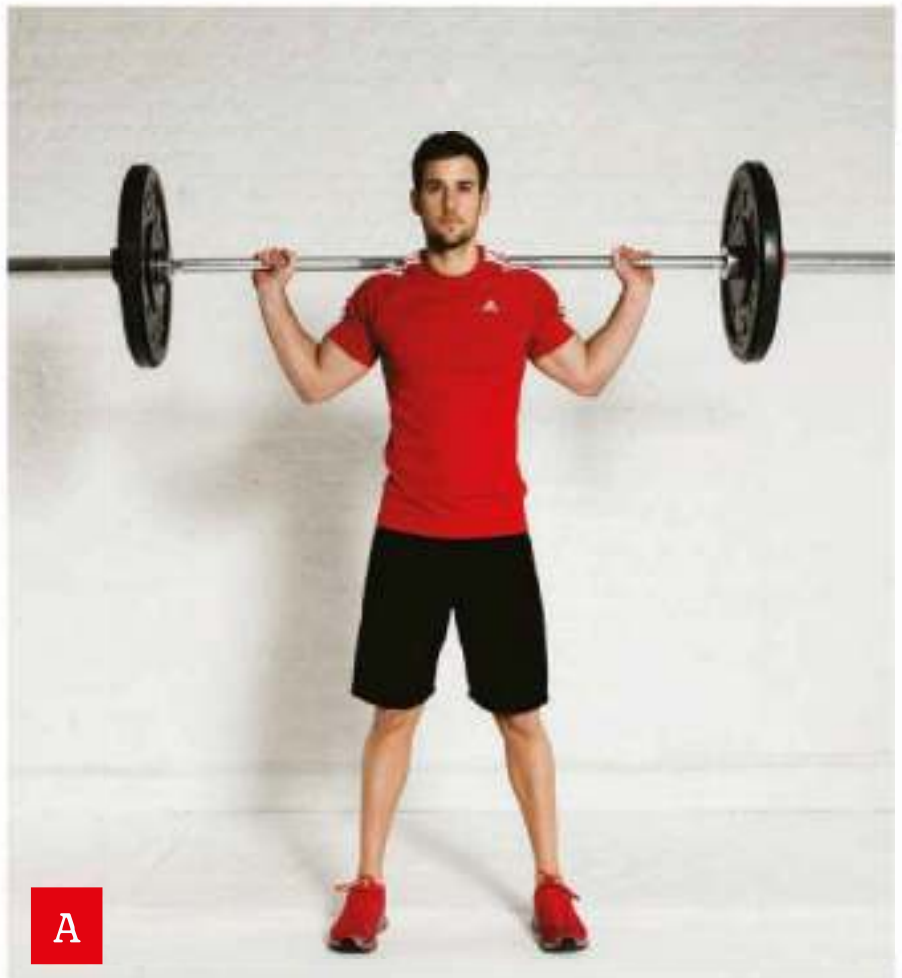
“Your head travels around the bar, not the other way around. Pull your head back as you press directly upwards.”



5 BACK SQUAT

Lower the bar on to your shoulders behind your head. Keep your chest up and lower into a squat, keeping your weight on your heels. Drive back up. Once you've finished all your reps, you can set the bar down.

“Don't rely on your quads. Activate your glutes by keeping your heels on the floor and your knees wide.”



Weight plate



The coach

Steve Kowalenko

The plan

“Repeat this workout two or three times a week, aiming to use a weight you can complete the whole complex with so you don’t have to put it down,” says Kowalenko. “As well as burning fat, it will improve your grip strength.”

Got a lot on your plate? Then use it – a weight plate, that is. You don’t need to spend hours on a treadmill to burn off belly fat efficiently. Training at a high intensity using weights and short rest periods is vastly more effective.

“All you need is a weight

plate and 15 minutes,” says Kowalenko, who created this minimalist complex workout.

Simply pick up a weight plate, perform all six moves back-to-back without setting it down until the last rep, then rest. Use the table below as a four-week plan, adding it to the end of

one of your current sessions as a fat-burning finisher.

“Unlike simple cardio, you’ll be using most of your body’s muscle mass with these exercises, so you’ll create a greater afterburn effect and keep torching fat long after you’ve finished,” says Kowalenko.

WEEK 1

SETS 3 REPS 6 REST 90sec

WEEK 2

SETS 3 REPS 8 REST 90sec

WEEK 3

SETS 3 REPS 10 REST 60sec

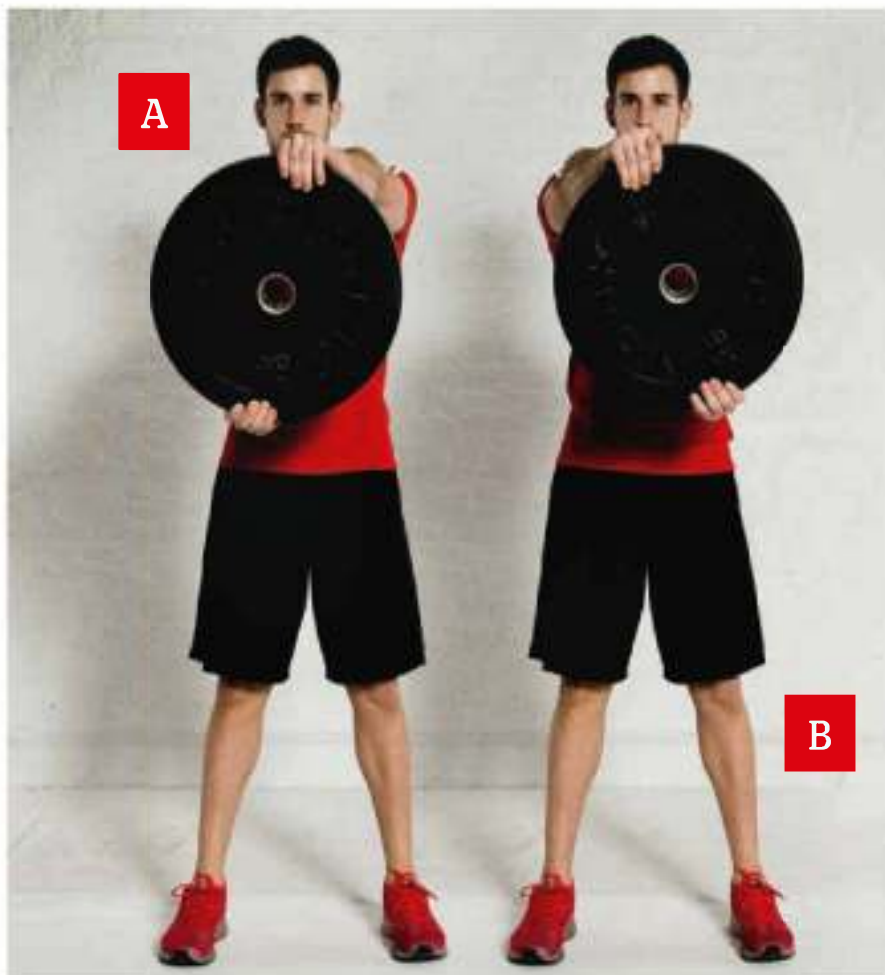
WEEK 4

SETS 4 REPS 10 REST 60sec

1 TRUCK DRIVER

Hold a weight plate at chest height with both arms outstretched. Rotate the plate as far as you can to the left as if turning a steering wheel, then to the right to complete one rep.

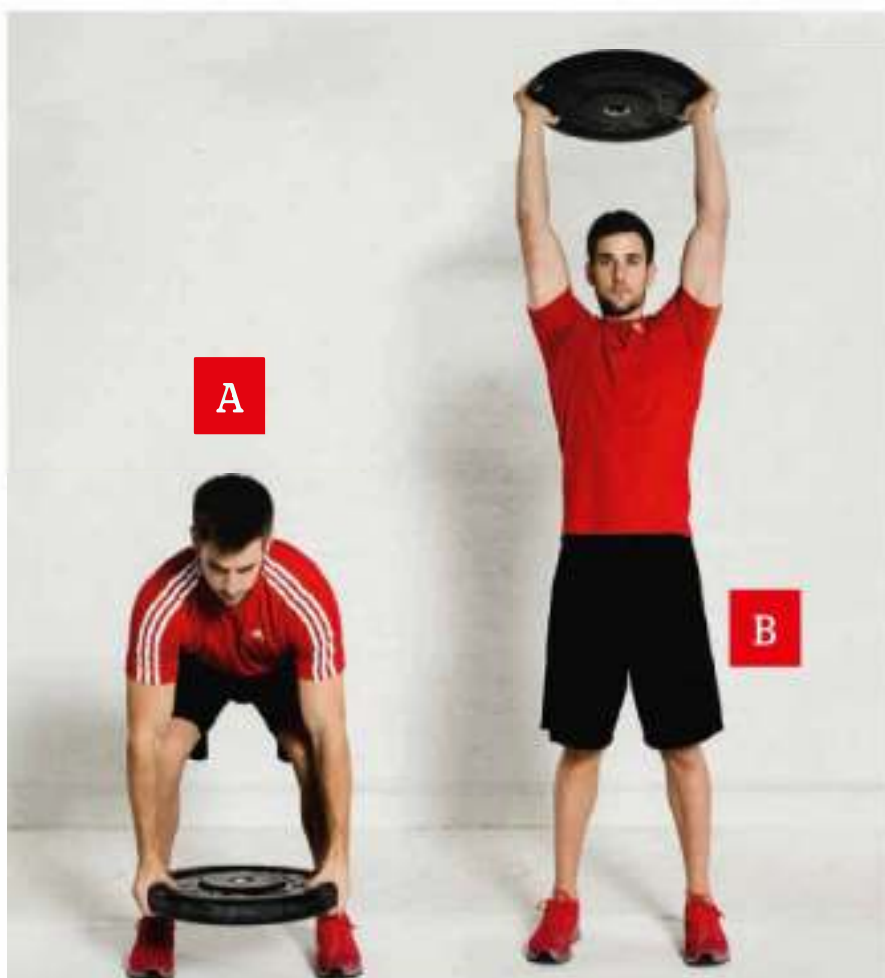
“Use your core strength to keep your chest up, taking pressure off your lower back,” says Kowalenko.



2 CLEAN AND PRESS

Bend your legs and bring the plate to shin height. Keeping your chest up and back straight, drive up and bring the plate up to press it overhead.

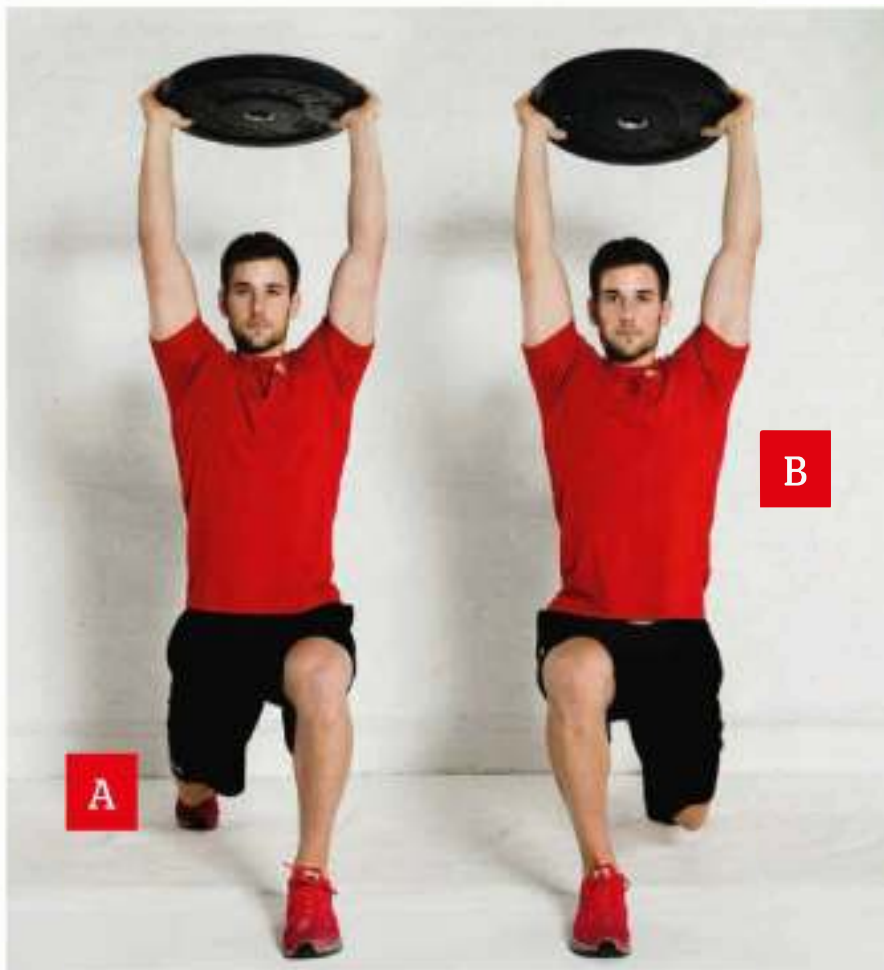
“Make sure you press fully overhead by bringing your biceps level with your ears.”



3 OVERHEAD LUNGE

With the plate held overhead, take a big step forwards, keeping your knee in line with your foot. Lower until your back knee is just off the floor, then drive back to standing and repeat on with the other leg to complete one rep.

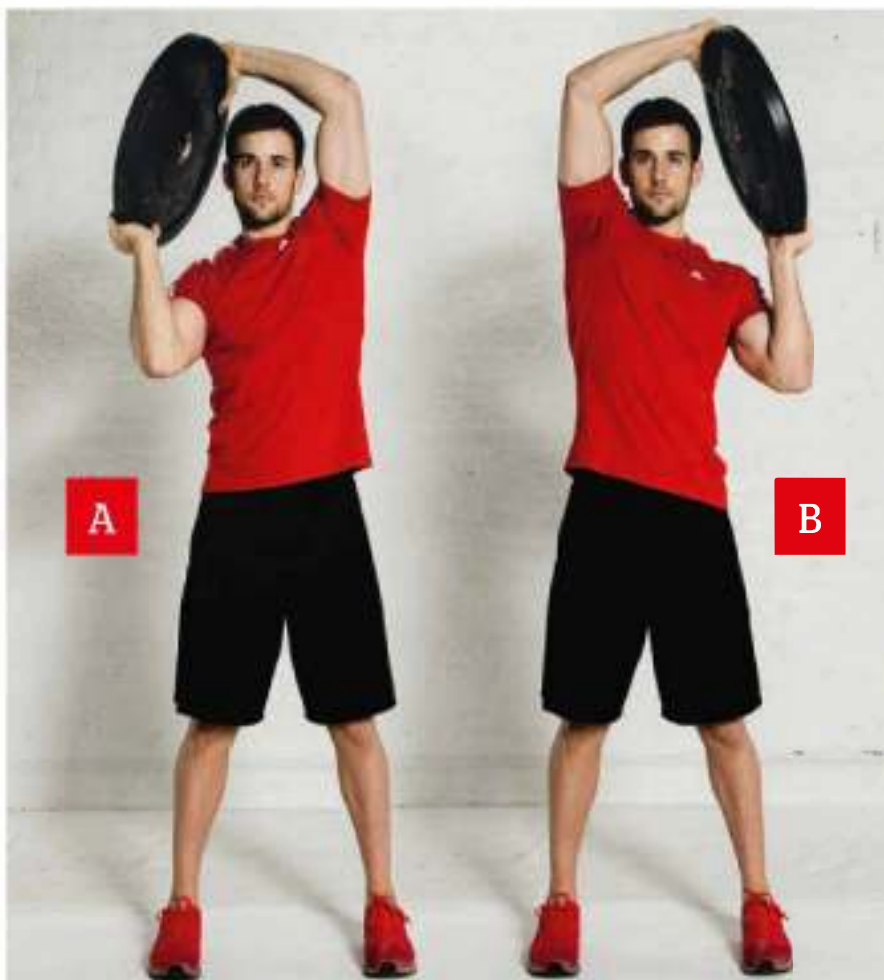
“Actively press the plate towards the ceiling so your upper back muscles help keep the weight stable.”



4 AROUND THE WORLD

From standing, hold the plate at head height. Keeping your core tight and head still, circle it around your head in one direction, then go back in the other direction to return to the start and complete one rep.

“Keep the movement slow and strict to challenge your core.”



5 JUMP SQUAT

Hold the plate to your chest. Lower into a squat, then drive up through your heels powerfully so that you leave the ground. Bend your legs to soften your landing and continue straight into the next rep.

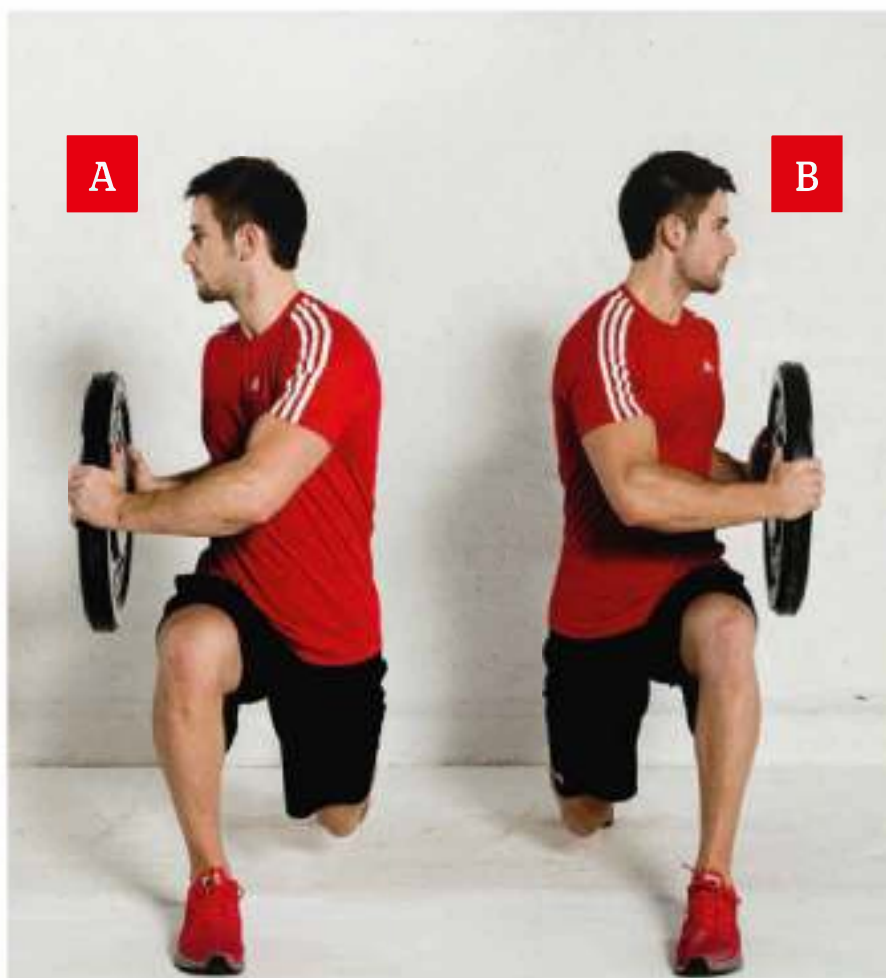
“Lower slowly, but explode up fast to get maximum height with each rep.”



6 LUNGE WITH ROTATION

Hold the plate in front of your chest with your arms bent. Take a big step forwards with one leg. As you lower your back knee, rotate your torso to the same side as your leading leg. Reverse the move to the start and repeat on the other leg to complete one rep.

“Squeeze your glutes to stabilise your body before rotating so you don’t twist your knee.”



Single kettlebell



The coach

**Natalie Morley is a
Fitness First trainer.**

The plan

“Repeat this workout two to three times a week, starting with a light kettlebell to perfect the form, then increasing the weight in weeks three and four as you get more competent,” says Morley.

Kettlebells are a fat-fighting godsend on their own, but combined with complexes - where you perform moves back to back without resting or setting the weight down - they create an unbeatable quick-fire workout combo.

“If you’re limited for time, space and equipment, this complex will guarantee a high-intensity session that burns fat

and develops strength,” says Morley. “Each move in this complex flows into the next, allowing for quick transitions and progression of movement patterns.

“This means you’ll develop functional strength and increased mobility at the same time as melting away belly fat.”

WEEK 1

SETS 3 REPS 8 REST 90sec

WEEK 2

SETS 4 REPS 10 REST 90sec

WEEK 3

SETS 4 REPS 8 REST 90sec

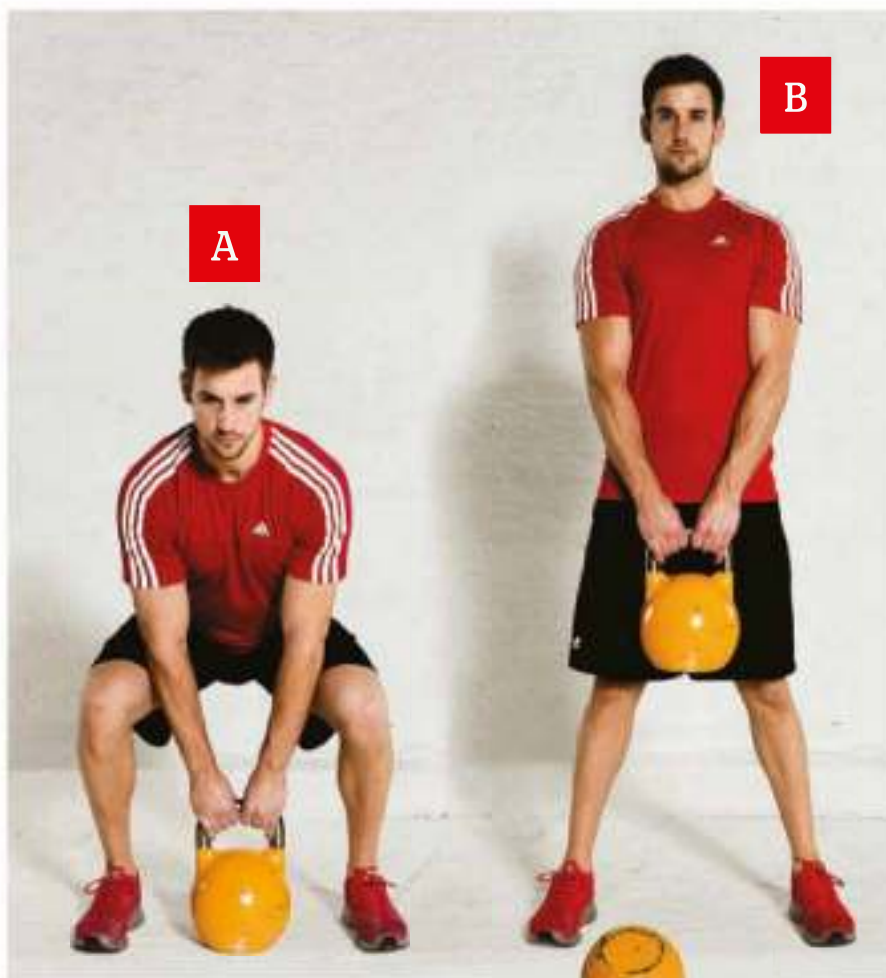
WEEK 4

SETS 4 REPS 8 REST 60sec

1 SUMO DEADLIFT

Hold the kettlebell with both hands and stand with your feet double shoulder-width apart. Squat, keeping your chest up and back straight, until your thighs are at least horizontal. Then drive back up.

“Protect your lower back by keeping your legs wide, which also targets your inner thighs, glutes and hamstrings,” says Morley.



2 TWO-ARM SWING

From standing, push the bell off your body to start the swing. Lower the bell, hinging at the hips by pushing your glutes back, keeping your chest up. When you feel a stretch in your hamstrings, power your hips forwards, keeping your feet flat on the floor and bringing the bell to head height.

“Keep your head and neck neutral throughout by letting your eyeline move up and down in time with the movement of your chest.”



3 SNATCH

Take one hand off the bell and bring it to your side for balance. Continue to swing the bell in

a similar way to the two-arm swing, but with more power to bring it higher. Once it passes eye level, pull your elbow up and back and quickly punch

up with your hand to catch the bell with a straight arm so it rests on the top of your forearm. Complete all the reps on one arm, then switch.

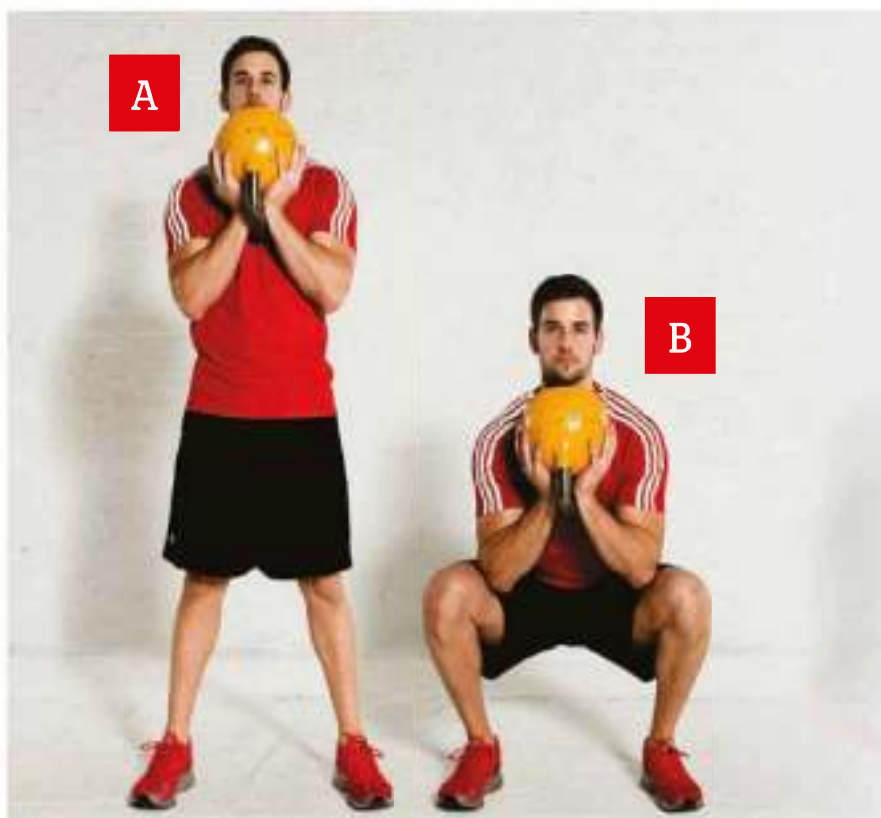
“Don’t grip too tight with the swing. Allow the bell to rotate easily so it doesn’t smash into your forearm.”



4 GOBLET SQUAT

Hold a bell upside down, with your palms close together and elbows tucked in. Keeping your back straight and chest up, lower into a deep squat. Drive through your heels to stand.

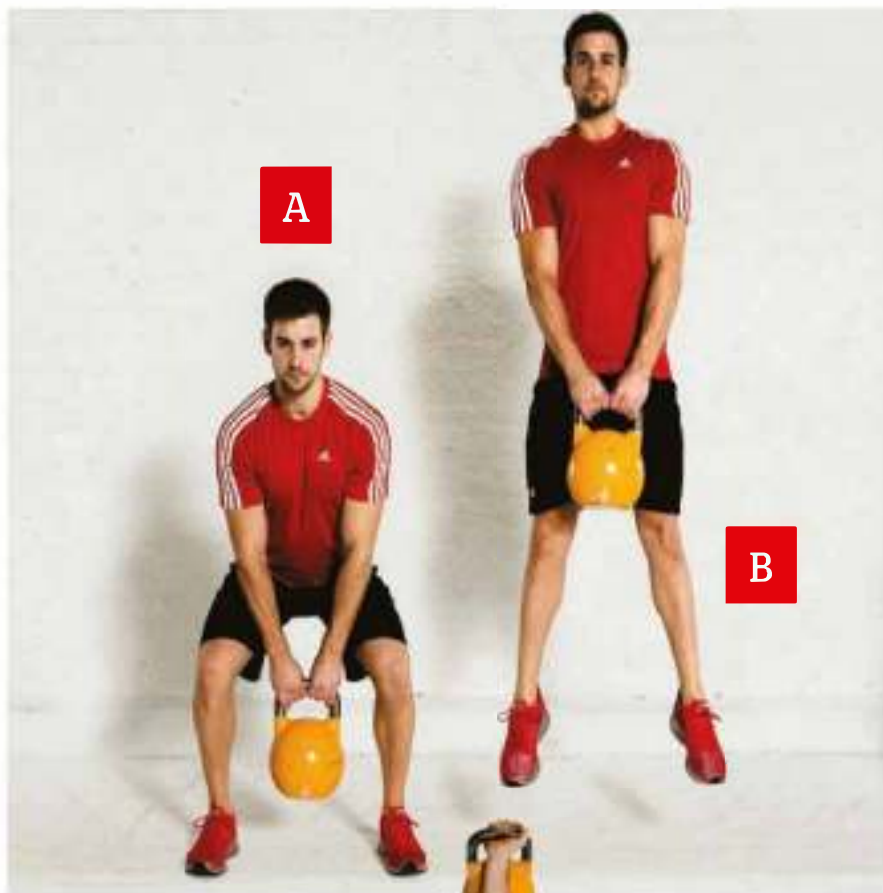
“Lead with your chest out of the bottom of the squat to ensure you don’t hunch your back.”



5 JUMP SQUAT

Grab the bell by the handles again, holding it between your legs with straight arms. Lower into a squat, keeping your chest up, then drive up explosively. Bend your knees to cushion your landing and continue into the next rep.

“Make your landing as light as possible and slow down the lowering part of the move to work your hamstrings.”



“Keep your thumbs pointed backwards as you press overhead so you don’t externally rotate your shoulders.”



6 CLEAN AND PRESS

Take one hand off the bell again and swing it in a similar way to the snatch but this time, as it passes eye level,

draw your elbow in to your body, bend your legs and catch the weight so it rests on the top of your forearm at

shoulder height. Now drive up to stand and punch the bell overhead. Complete all the reps on one arm, then switch.

Muscle workouts

These week-long training plans will help you achieve your fitness goals and build the body you want

Every plan in this section features a week's worth of workouts, designed by an expert coach, which you can repeat for four to eight weeks to build serious muscle to suit your training goals.

Terminology decoded

REPS

Abbreviation of repetitions. One rep is the completion of a given exercise from start to finish through a full range of motion.

SETS

A given number of reps of a single exercise performed consecutively without rest

REST

The time you take between exercises and/or sets, during which your muscles and lungs are given the chance to recover.

TEMPO

The tempo of each move, expressed as a four-digit figure. The first digit is how long in seconds you should take to lower the weight, the second how long to pause at the bottom, the third how long you should take to lift and the fourth how long to pause at the top. X means to perform that phase explosively.

SUPERSET

In a superset complete a set of exercise A then move on to a set of exercise B without rest. Rest as instructed then go back to exercise A.

TRI-SET

A tri-set follows the same protocol as a superset. Perform exercises A, B and C back-to-back with no rest between moves, rest as instructed after exercise C, then return to exercise A.

BUILT FOR ATHLETESTM

FITNESS BACKPACKS

FOR THOSE THAT TRAIN HARDER



YKK Zippers



Side Compression Straps



2 x Elastic Mesh
Side Bottle Holders



600D Waterproof
Material

46cm/18.1in



30cm/11.8in



Full Velcro Top Pocket
For Personalisation



Reinforced Padding



Laser Cut
Molle Webbing

Hollywood muscle

Get in blockbuster shape with the definitive action hero workout plan



The coach

David Kingsbury is the action hero's go-to personal trainer. Based at Pinewood Film Studios, he's long worked with Wolverine's Hugh Jackman and trained the cast of X-Men: Days of Future Past.

Question: how do you train a 100-year-old mutant, a shape-shifter and the master of magnetism in shape?

Answer: the same as anyone else!

"All my plans achieve results with the same formula: heavy weights, progressive overload and hard work," says Kingsbury, who graduated from being Hugh Jackman's personal trainer to taking on almost all of Professor Xavier's academy. "There are no Hollywood secrets when it comes to getting in shape."

The most important factors, says Kingsbury, are nutrition and consistency. "The primary design of this plan is to increase size and strength, but that will only happen if you follow the right food plan. For muscle gain, eat 10-20% above your daily maintenance of calories while using this plan.

"For strength, eat 10% above your maintenance levels and for fat loss, add 20-minute interval

sprints (rounds of 30-second sprints and 90-second walks) twice a week and eat 10-20% below your maintenance levels for a calorie deficit.

"Get your diet right, and then this plan, which includes max reps sets and high-volume 50-rep challenges, will take care of the rest."

So we might not be able to give you mutant super powers, but we can give you the plan that forged Hugh Jackman's formidable physique for X-Men's Wolverine! And of course, resistance training is proven to strengthen your bones. Not quite adamantium, but not miles off!

How to do these workouts

This plan is made up of classic body-part splits such as chest and back days and legs days.

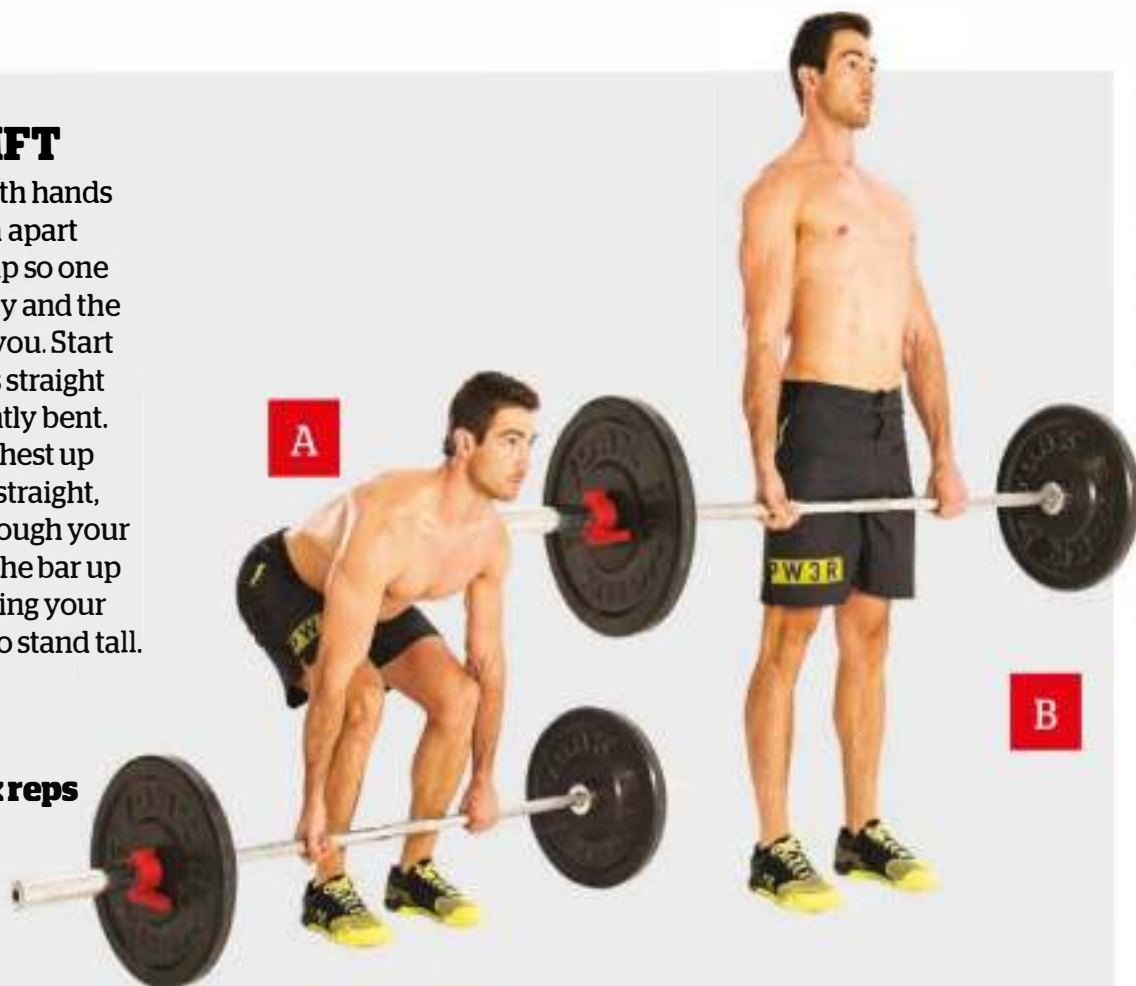
Ideally, do the four workouts in order, resting a day between each when possible.

"This plan will increase size and strength, but only if you follow the right food plan. Get your diet right and this plan will take care of the rest"

1 DEADLIFT

Hold the bar with hands shoulder-width apart and a mixed grip so one palm faces away and the other towards you. Start with your arms straight and knees slightly bent. Keeping your chest up and your back straight, drive down through your heels and pull the bar up your legs, pushing your hips forwards to stand tall.

SETS 5
REPS 4 + max reps
TEMPO 2010
REST 2 min



2 ROMANIAN DEADLIFT

Keeping your legs slightly bent and back straight, lean forwards from the hips, not the waist, and lower the bar down the front of your shins until you feel a moderate stretch in your hamstrings. Reverse the move, pushing your hips forwards to stand.

SETS 4
REPS 8
TEMPO 2010
REST 90 sec



3 BARBELL OVERHEAD PRESS

Stand with your feet shoulder-width apart, holding the bar with hands just wider than shoulder-width apart. Brace your core and glutes to keep your balance and press the bar overhead. Lower it until it's sitting on the top of your chest.

SETS **5**
REPS **8**
TEMPO **2010**
REST **60 sec**



1A BENCH PRESS

Lie on a flat bench holding the bar with an overhand grip, hands just wider than shoulder-width apart. Drive your feet hard into the floor and press the weights straight up powerfully, then lower them slowly to the start position.

SETS 5

REPS 4+ max reps

TEMPO 2010

REST 60 sec



1B BENT-OVER ROW

Bend your knees slightly and hinge forwards from the hips, keeping your back slightly concave, and your shoulder blades back throughout. Holding the bar with an overhand grip just outside your legs, pull the weight up to your lower sternum, then lower slowly.

SETS 5

REPS 8

TEMPO 2010

REST 60 sec



2A DUMBBELL INCLINE BENCH

Lie on a bench set to a 45° angle, holding the dumbbells beside your chest so your palms are facing your feet. Keeping your feet planted on the floor, powerfully press the dumbbells straight overhead, lower them slowly until they're level with your chest, then repeat.

SETS 4
REPS 10
TEMPO 2010
REST 30 sec

A

B



1 DUMBBELL CALF RAISE

Holding dumbbells, stand on a step or stack of weight plates so your heels are hanging over the edge. Lower your heels slowly, pause, then tense your calves and explosively push up on to the balls of your feet. Pause at the top, keeping your calves tense, then return to the start.

SETS 4
REPS 10
TEMPO 21X1
REST 60 sec

A



B



2 BACK SQUAT

With your feet just wider than shoulder-width apart, rest the bar on the back of your shoulders. With your chest up and core braced, squat until your thighs are at least parallel to the floor. Drive back up through your heels to stand.

SETS 5
REPS 4 + max reps
TEMPO 2010
REST 2 min

A



B



4 DUMBBELL FRONT SQUAT

Hold the dumbbells at shoulder height with palms facing forwards. Keeping your chest up and back straight, squat until your thighs pass parallel, then drive back up.

SETS 4
REPS 20
TEMPO 2010
REST 60sec

A

B

1A PULL-UP

Grasp a bar with an overhand grip so your palms are facing away from you and your hands are double shoulder-width apart. Contract your upper back muscles to help pull your sternum towards the bar, then lower under control. If you can handle five reps easily, add weight using a weight belt or by holding a dumbbell between your feet.

SETS 5
REPS 4 + max reps
TEMPO 2010
REST 60 sec



1B INCLINE DUMBBELL BENCH PRESS

Lie on a bench set at a 45° angle, holding dumbbells beside your chest. Drive your feet into the floor and press the weights straight overhead, then lower slowly to the start.

SETS 5
REPS 10
TEMPO 2010
REST 60 sec



1C RING INVERTED ROW

Hold the rings and hang so your body forms a straight line, with your heels on the floor and your core braced. Squeeze your shoulder blades together and pull yourself up, drawing your hands towards your armpits. Pause, then lower slowly.

SETS **4**

REPS **12**

TEMPO **2010**

REST **90sec**

A

B

Build strength & power

Harness the muscle-growing powers of your bodyweight with workouts 1-3, then step it up a notch by trying out the specialist circuits A-C.



The coach

Andy McKenzie (combinedstrength.com) is a well-respected strength coach, speaker and fitness. He's also an expert in bodyweight and core conditioning.

The power is in your hands...

In fact it's in your arms, legs and torso too, because all you need to get strong and lean is your body. "Bodyweight training is strength training," says McKenzie. "It's a huge step on the journey to physical dominance and all you need to stay in shape for life."

The moves in this plan are beginner-friendly and designed to help you burn fat - but they'll also make you stronger and more muscular. So as well as helping you look ripped, they'll ensure your workouts continue to challenge you as the additional muscle mass means the bodyweight you

shift increases. The plan can be done in the gym, but the exercises have been chosen so you can perform it at home, the garden, or even in the park. All you need is a medicine ball, plus a TRX or rings for suspension moves, and a sturdy tree branch to substitute for the moves that include a pull-up station.

Once-a-week core-focused days will fix any chinks in your body armour, benefiting both your bodyweight training and your compound lifts, so when it's time to return to the barbell you'll be able to (metaphorically!) punch it through the roof.



The coach

Will Girling is a performance nutritionist, PT, corrective movements specialist (willgirling.com).

To really increase your strength, we've put together some power circuits using barbells and dumbbells.

Coach Will Girling also specialises in strongman training techniques, which build impressive lean muscle and cardio, and also shift stubborn body fat.

"Doing big, heavy compound movements stimulates your muscles and central nervous system, causing you to release more growth hormone and raising your metabolism," he says.

"Ultimately this increases the calories your body burns throughout the day, boosts your fitness and cranks up the potential of muscle growth. And the hard and fast medley sessions in each workout are a close simulation of what you might get in a strongman competition."

1 RING-ASSISTED PISTOL SQUAT

Stand on one leg, with the other off the floor and straight in front of you, holding the rings to maintain your balance. Bend your standing leg to lower into a single-leg squat, then press back up to stand. Aim to use the rings as little as possible.

SETS 5
REPS 4 each side
TEMPO 2010
REST 45 sec



2 MEDICINE BALL SQUAT

Stand holding a medicine ball or large rock straight out in front of you, feet shoulder-width apart. With your chest high and core tight, squat until your thighs are below parallel to the floor. Sit back on your heels - don't let them come off the floor. Drive back up through your heels to stand.

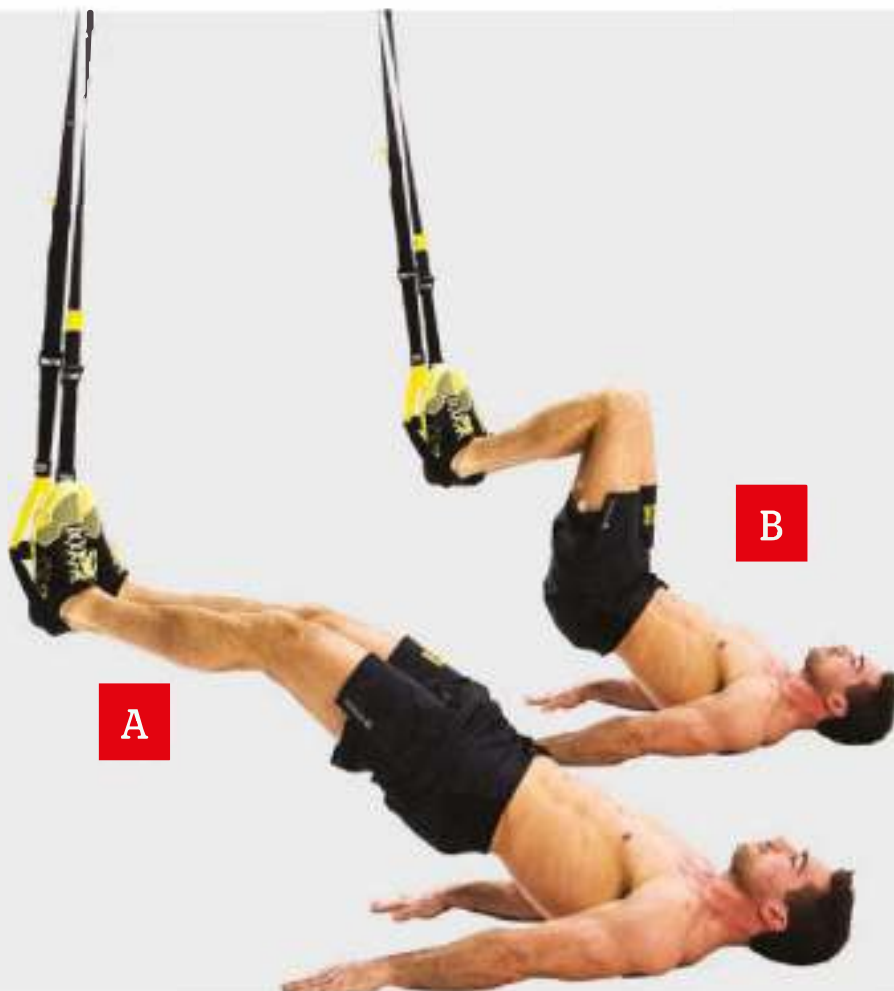
SETS 4
REPS 6
TEMPO 4410
REST 60 sec



3A TRX HAMSTRING CURL

Sit on the floor in front of the TRX, place both heels in the loops and lie back, lifting your hips off the floor. Keep both feet flexed towards your shins and your knees close together. Press your heels into the foot cradles, raise your hips and pull your heels towards your glutes. Return to the start.

SETS 3
REPS 12
TEMPO 2010
REST 0sec

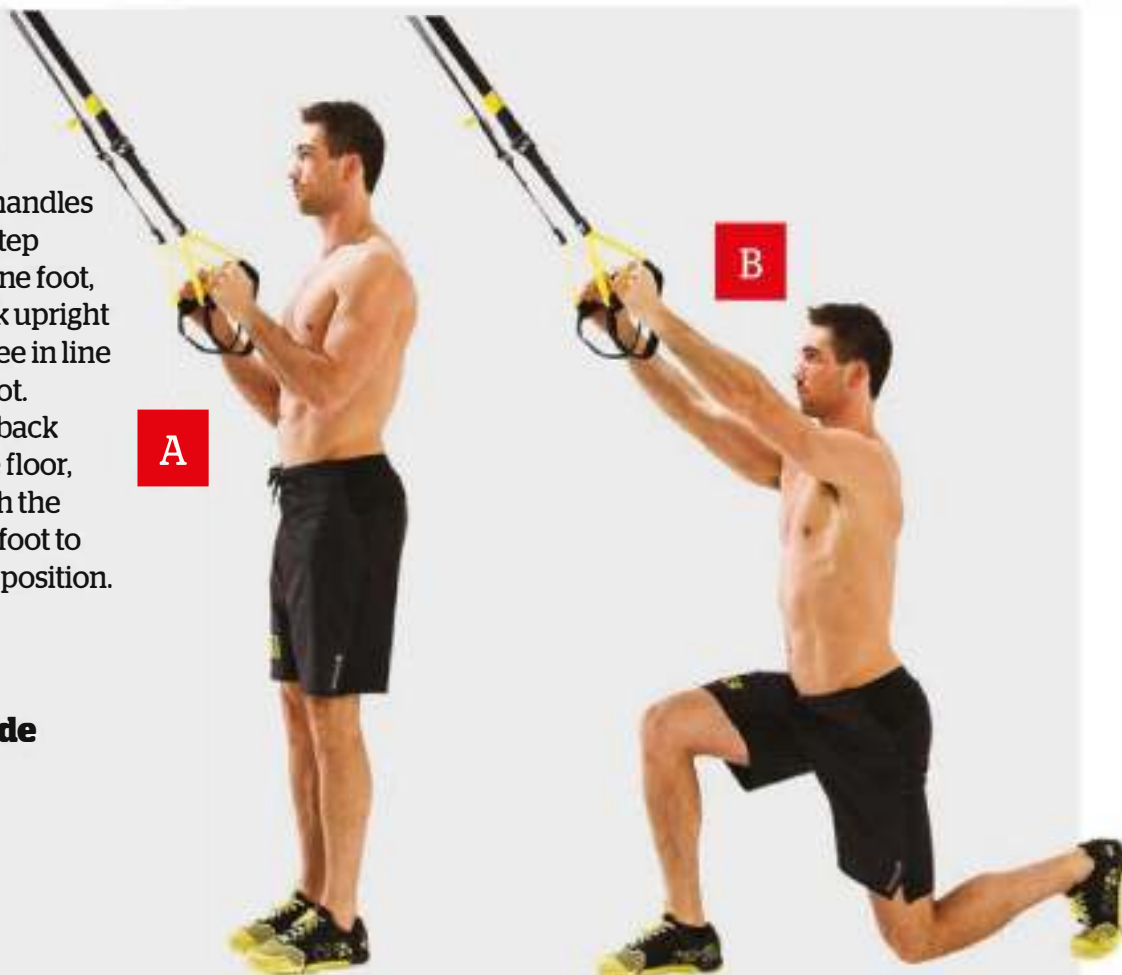


3B TRX REVERSE LUNGE

Holding the TRX handles lightly, take a big step backwards with one foot, keeping your back upright and your front knee in line with your front foot.

Lower until your back knee is just off the floor, then drive through the heel of your front foot to return to the start position. Alternate legs.

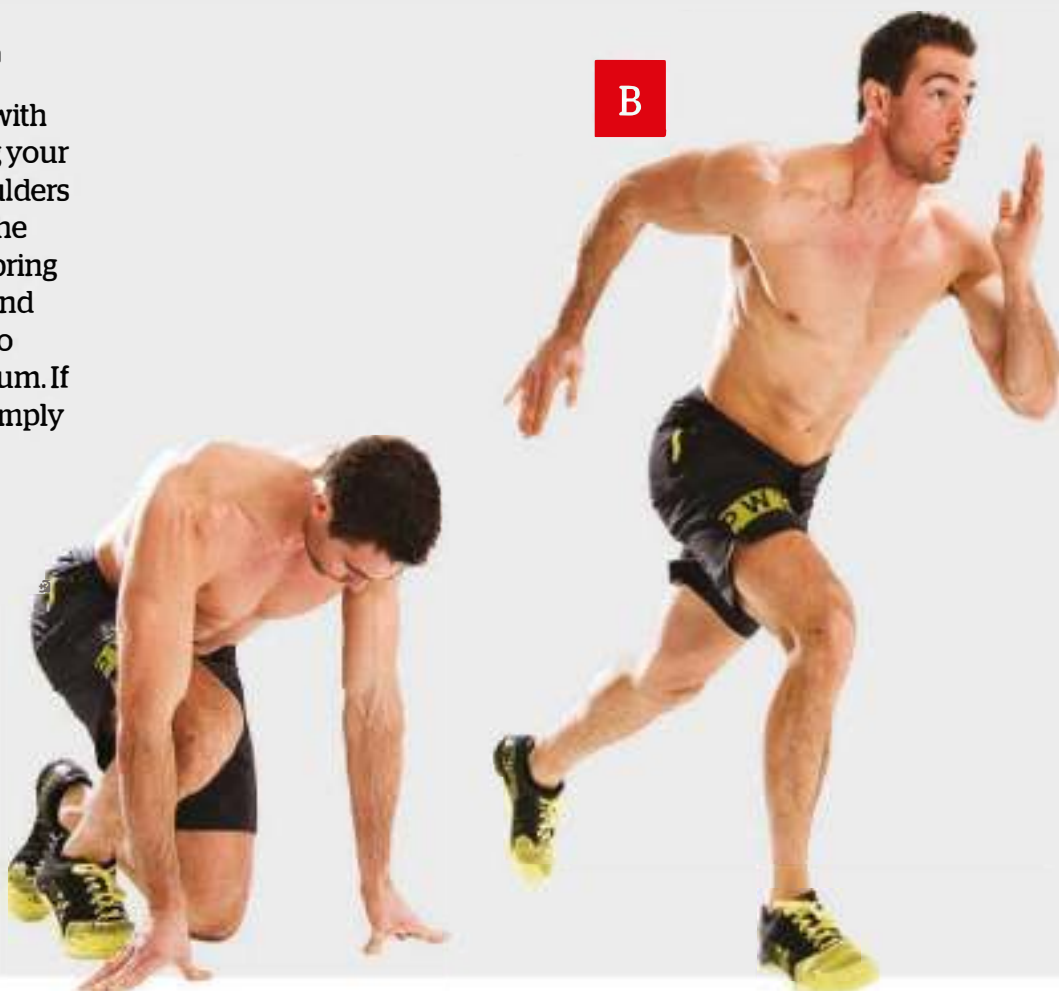
SETS 3
REPS 12 each side
TEMPO 2010
REST 60sec



4A SPRINT

Drive powerfully with each step, keeping your core tight but shoulders relaxed. Push off the balls of your feet, bring your knees high, and pump your arms to generate momentum. If there's no room, simply run on the spot!

SETS 2
DISTANCE 50M
TEMPO N/A
REST 0 sec



4B WALKING LUNGE

Lunge forwards, keeping your back upright and your front knee in line with your front foot. Lower until your back knee is just off the floor, then drive through the heel of your front foot to stand. Continue straight into a lunge with your other leg.

SETS 2
DISTANCE 50M
TEMPO 1010
REST 60 sec





A

1A GORILLA PRESS-UP

Start in the top press-up position. Slowly lower to the ground, then explode up as fast as possible and bring your hands off the floor to slap them against your chest. Put your hands back out to land and go into the next rep.

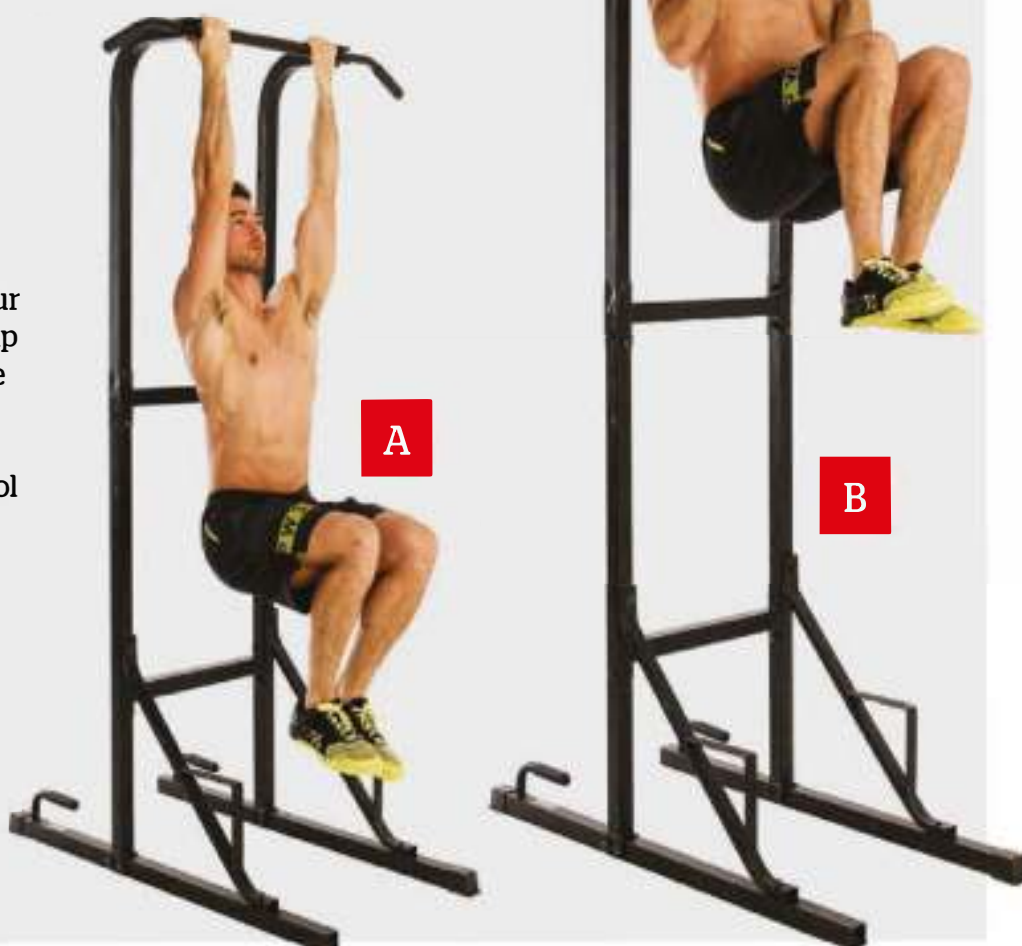
B

C

SETS 5
REPS 5
TEMPO 10X0
REST 0sec

1B KNEE RAISE CHIN-UP

Hold a chin-up bar (or a sturdy branch or climbing frame!) with an underhand grip, hands shoulder-width apart. Brace your core, raise your knees and pull yourself up until your chin is over the bar, keeping your elbows tucked in close to your body. Lower under control without lowering your thighs below parallel.



A

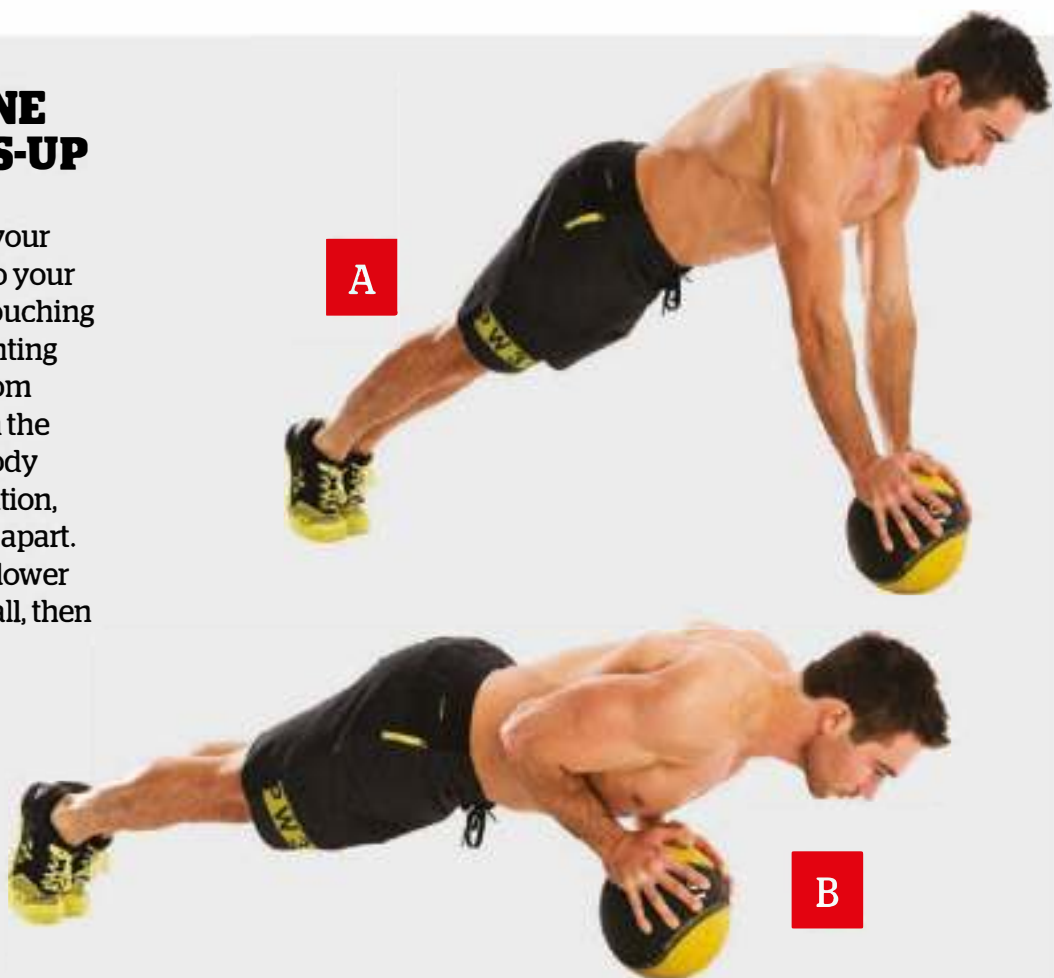
B

SETS 5
REPS 5
TEMPO 3011
REST 60 sec

2A MEDICINE BALL PRESS-UP

Kneel in front of a medicine ball. Put your hands on the ball so your palms are almost touching and fingers are pointing diagonally away from you. Press down on the ball to raise your body into a press-up position, with feet hip-width apart. Bend your arms to lower your chest to the ball, then press back up.

SETS 4
REPS 10
TEMPO 2010
REST 0sec



2B TRX ONE-ARM ROW

Hold the TRX handles with one hand and hang so your body forms a straight line with your heels on the floor and your core braced. Squeeze your shoulder blades together and pull yourself up with one arm, keeping the other arm extended in front of you and drawing the handles towards your armpit. Return to the start.

SETS 4
REPS 10
TEMPO 2010
REST 60sec





3A BEAR CRAWL

Get on all fours, with your arms and legs slightly bent and your hips raised as high as possible. Keeping your hips high and your core strong, crawl forward. Keep the move slow and controlled. Measure the length of the space you're using first so you can keep track of your metres.

SETS 3

DISTANCE 20M

TEMPO N/A

REST 0 sec



3B CRAB WALK

Sit down and put your hands and feet on the floor. Drive your hips up and engage your glutes to keep them high as you walk forwards in the direction of your knees.

SETS 3

DISTANCE 20M

TEMPO N/A

REST 45 sec



1 TOES-TO-BAR

Hang from a pull-up bar with an overhand grip. Contract your core and bring your legs up together so your toes touch the bar, then lower to the start under control.

SETS 3

REPS 5

TEMPO 1010

REST 60 sec



2 HANGING KNEE RAISE

Hang from a pull-up bar with an overhand grip. Contract your core and bring your knees up until they're level with your chest, then slowly lower under control.

SETS 3

REPS 12

TEMPO 1010

REST 60 sec

3A SQUAT THRUST

Start in the top press-up position with your feet close together. Jump your legs forwards into a tuck, keeping your hands on the floor, then jump back to the start.

SETS **3**
TIME **40sec**
TEMPO **1010**
REST **0sec**



3B SPRINT

Drive powerfully with each step, keeping your core tight and shoulders relaxed. Push off the balls of your feet, bring your knees high and pump your arms to generate momentum. If there's no room, run on the spot.

SETS **3**
TIME **20sec**
TEMPO **N/A**
REST **0sec**



3C FRONT LEANING REST

Start in the top press-up position with your hands shoulder-width apart and feet together. Keep your body in line and hands directly under your shoulders. Squeeze your abs and core to help you keep your hips up.

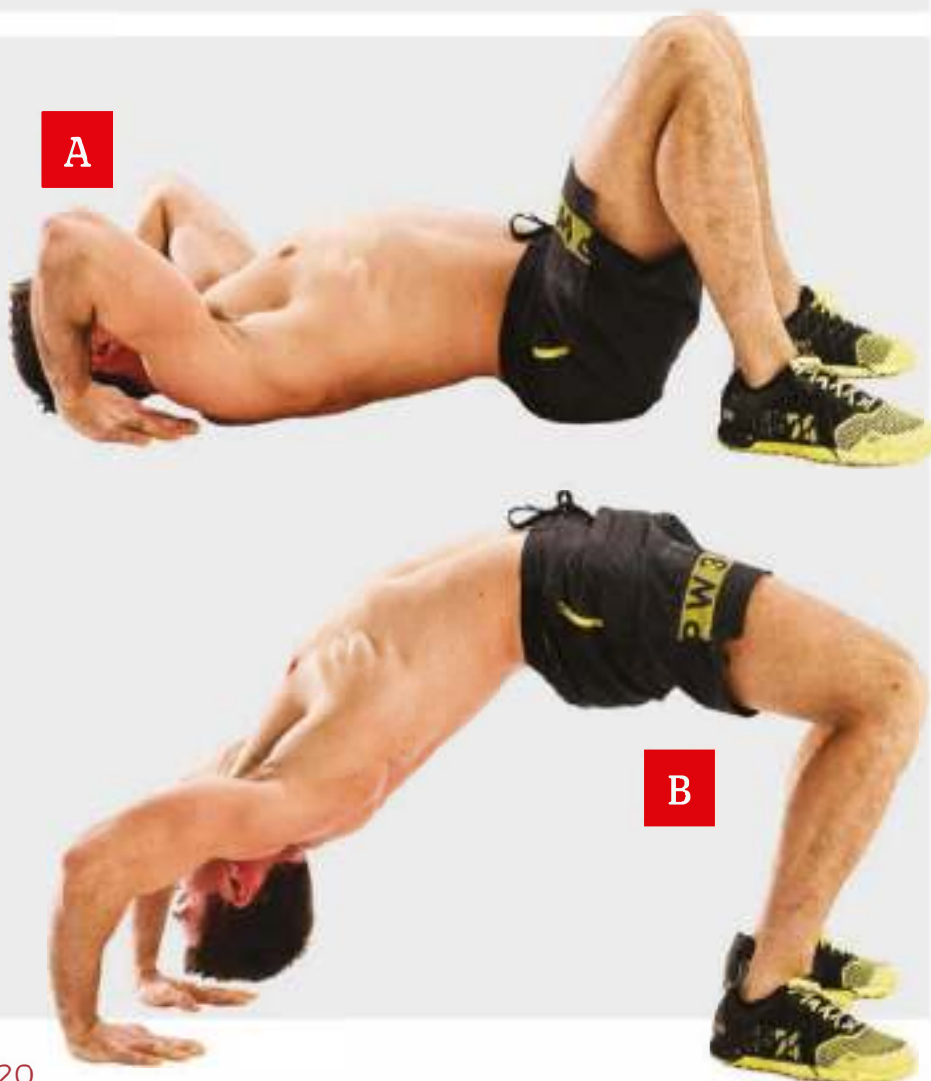
SETS 3
TIME 60 sec
TEMPO N/A
REST 60 sec



4 BACK BRIDGE

Lie on your back with your legs bent and feet planted on the floor. Put your hands on the floor above your shoulders with your palms down and fingers pointing towards your feet. Press down into the floor with your hands and feet, and thrust your hips high to form a curved bridge with your body. Squeeze your glutes to keep your body stable.

SETS 3
TIME Max hold
TEMPO N/A
REST 45 sec



1 BACK SQUAT

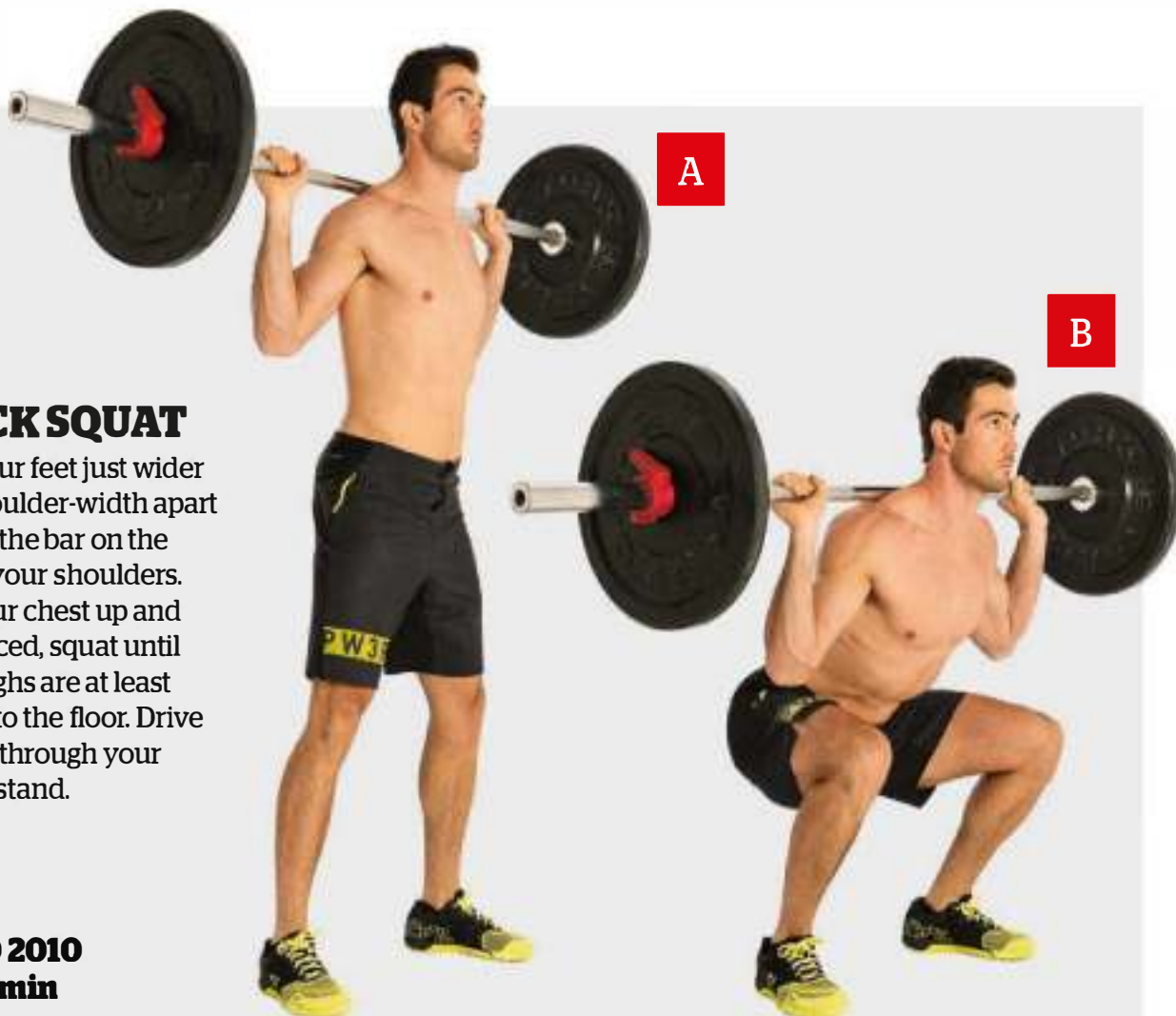
Place your feet just wider than shoulder-width apart and rest the bar on the back of your shoulders. With your chest up and core braced, squat until your thighs are at least parallel to the floor. Drive back up through your heels to stand.

SETS 5

REPS 5

TEMPO 2010

REST 2 min



2 SEATED DUMBBELL OVERHEAD PRESS

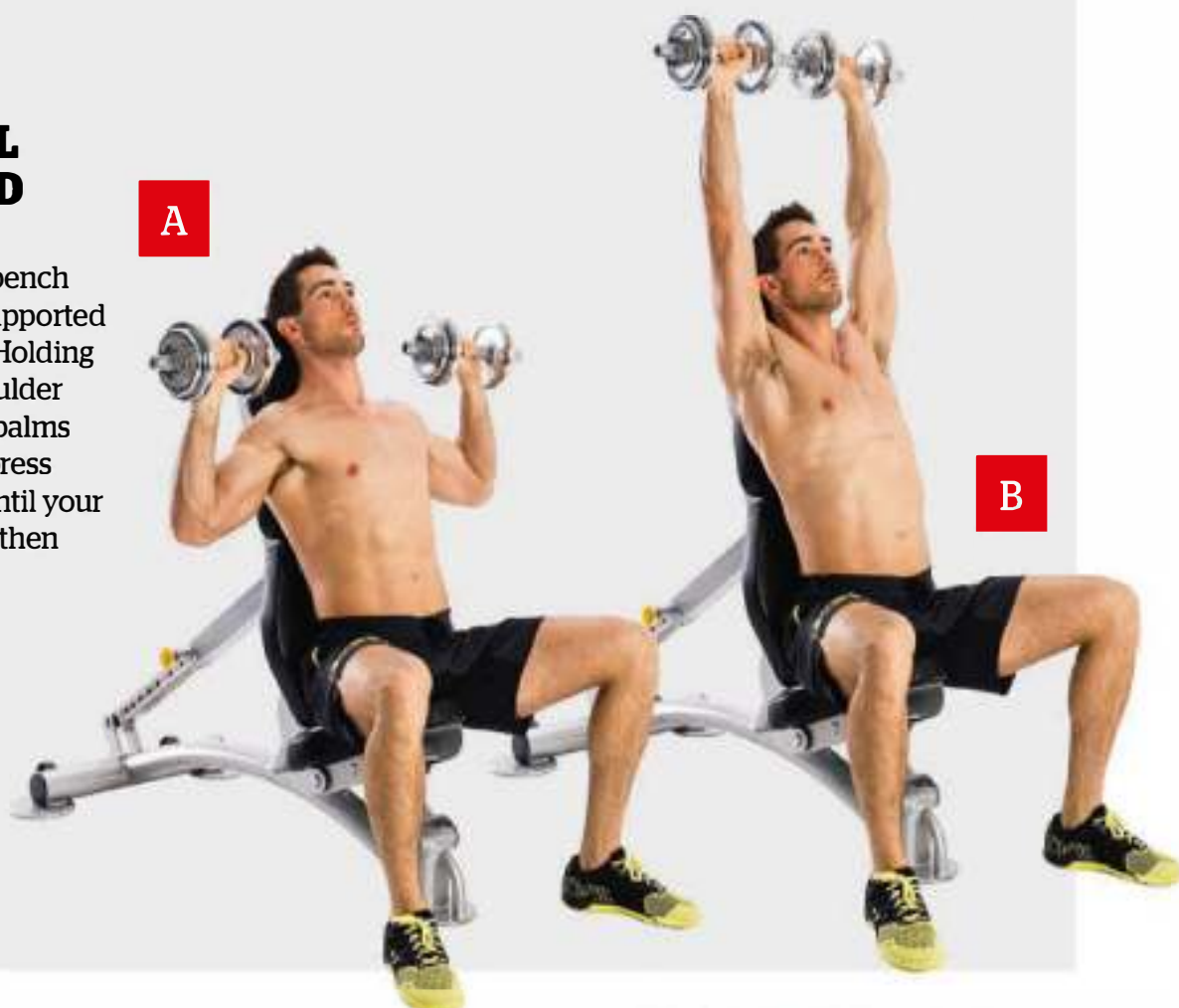
Sit on an upright bench with your back supported and core braced. Holding dumbbells at shoulder height with your palms facing forwards, press them overhead until your arms are straight, then lower.

SETS 4

REPS 8

TEMPO 2010

REST 2 min



3 SUMO DEADLIFT

Stand with feet wide apart. Keeping your chest up, bend your legs and grasp the barbell with hands less than shoulder-width apart, using a mixed grip so one palm faces forwards and one back. Keep your core braced as you push through your heels to raise the weight, driving your hips forwards to stand tall before reversing the move to the start.

SETS **5**
REPS **5**
TEMPO **2010**
REST **2 min**



4A SINGLE-ARM ROW

Wedge a barbell into the middle of a weight plate on the floor and hold the other end of the bar with one hand, facing away from its anchor point. Bend your legs and hinge forwards at your hips so your back is almost parallel with the floor. Keeping your core strong and shoulder blades retracted, row the bar towards your armpit, drawing your elbow upwards, then lower until your arm is straight.

SETS **4**
REPS **8 each side**
TEMPO **2010**
REST **0 sec**



4B ROMANIAN DEADLIFT

Keeping your legs slightly bent and back straight, lean forwards from the hips, not the waist, and lower the bar down the front of your shins until you feel a moderate stretch in your hamstrings. Reverse the move, pushing your hips forwards to stand.

SETS **4**
REPS **8**
TEMPO **2010**
REST **1 min**



5 STRAIGHT-LEG SIT-UP

Lie on the floor with your feet together and fingers at your temples. Squeeze your core to press your lower back into the floor then, keeping your core braced, contract your abs to raise your upper body, making sure not to raise your legs.

SETS **4**
REPS **8**
TEMPO **2010**
REST **1 min**



1 FRONT SQUAT

Rest the bar across your upper chest with your hands holding it in place and your elbows as high as you can get them. Keeping your chest up and back straight, squat until your thighs pass parallel, then drive back up to standing.

SETS 5
REPS 5
TEMPO 2010
REST 2 min



2 DUMBBELL MILITARY PRESS

Stand with your feet together holding dumbbells with your upper arms horizontal and palms facing forwards. Brace your core and glutes to keep your balance and press the weights straight up so your biceps are close to your ears, then lower to the start.

SETS 5
REPS 5
TEMPO 2010
REST 2 min



3A MEADOWS ROW

With the bar wedged into a weight plate on the floor, hold the other end and stand side-on to it. Use a hook grip so all your fingers and thumb are on the same side of the bar, thumb closest to your body. Bend your knees and hinge forwards at the hips so your back is almost parallel to the floor, then row the bar towards your armpit. Keep your core braced and shoulder blades retracted.

SETS 4
REPS 8 each side
TEMPO 2011
REST 0 sec



3B BARBELL HIP THRUST

Sit on the floor with your back against a bench and a loaded barbell lying across your body just above your hips. Plant your feet on the floor. Drive through your heels and contract your glutes hard to raise your hips and the bar off the floor until your body is at least parallel to the ground - ideally so your hips should be higher than your knees. Lower until your glutes are just off the floor.

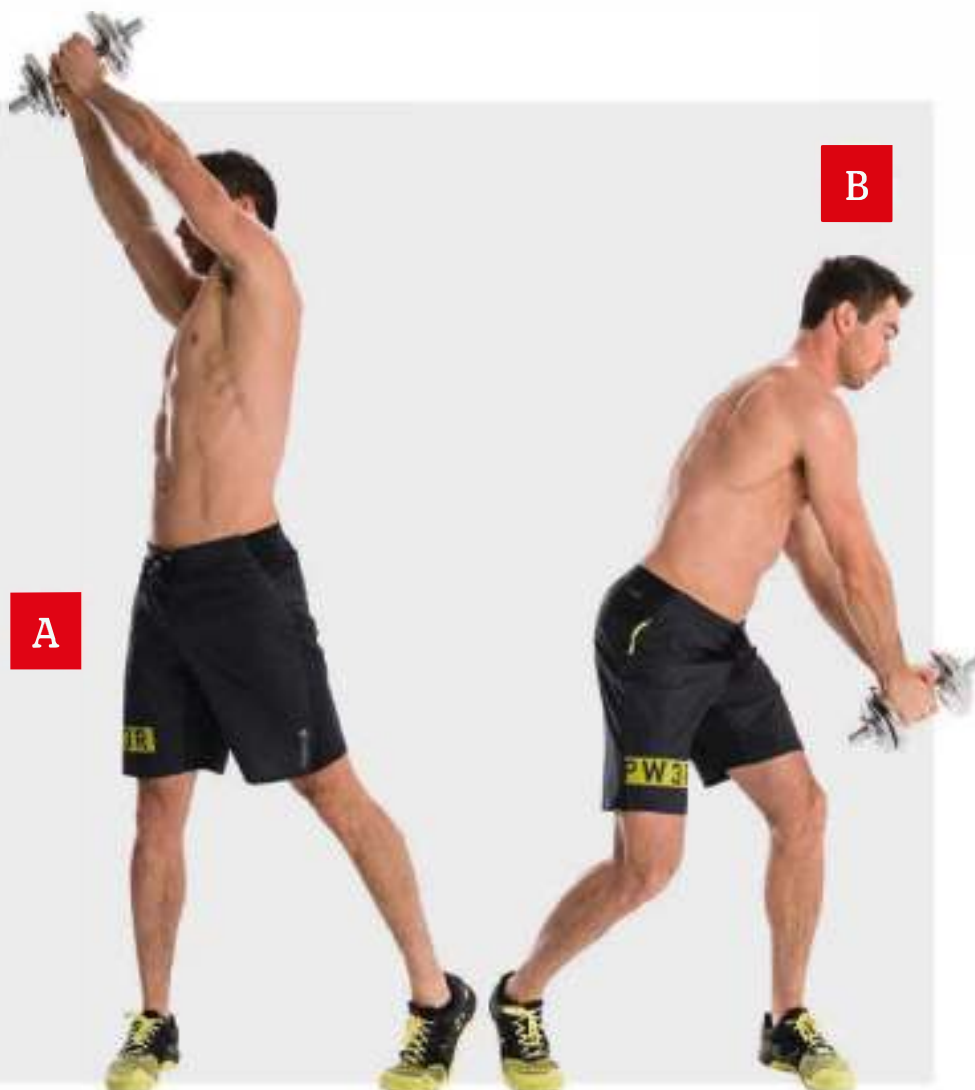
SETS 4
REPS 8
TEMPO 2011
REST 1 min



4A DUMBBELL WOODCHOP

Hold a dumbbell in both hands up and out to one side, pivoting your foot on the opposite side to take the pressure off your knee. Bracing your core throughout, powerfully bring the dumbbell down and across you, pivoting your other knee as you go. Slowly return to the start.

SETS **4**
REPS **8 each side**
TEMPO **2010**
REST **0 sec**



4B BARBELL ROLL-OUT

Kneel in front of a loaded barbell, holding it with a shoulder-width overhand grip. Keep your arms straight and shoulders and core braced, and roll the bar out as far as you can without collapsing. Reverse the move back to the start.

SETS **4**
REPS **8**
TEMPO **2020**
REST **1 min**



Do all six exercises in order, taking 30 seconds to perform each one. Rest for three minutes after one round, then repeat the whole circuit. Complete a total of six rounds, focusing on good form and fast reps. You should come away from each out of breath.

1 SNATCH-GRIP DEADLIFT

Hold the bar with hands double shoulder-width apart, arms straight and shoulder blades retracted. Keeping your chest up and your back straight, drive down through your heels and push your hips forwards as you pull the bar up your legs to stand tall.

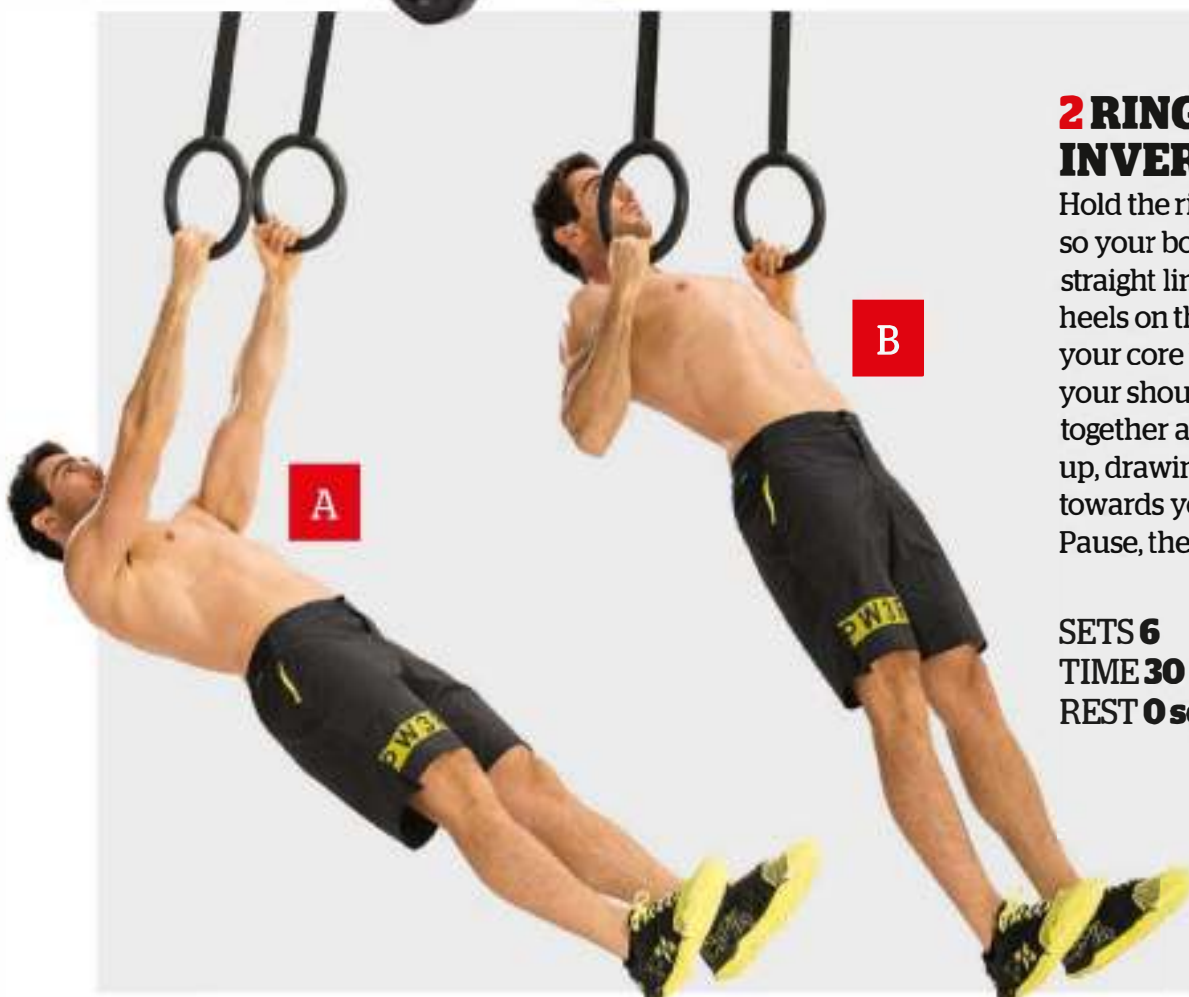
SETS 6
TIME 30 sec
REST 0 sec



2 RING INVERTED ROW

Hold the rings and hang so your body forms a straight line, with your heels on the floor and your core braced. Squeeze your shoulder blades together and pull yourself up, drawing your hands towards your armpits. Pause, then lower slowly.

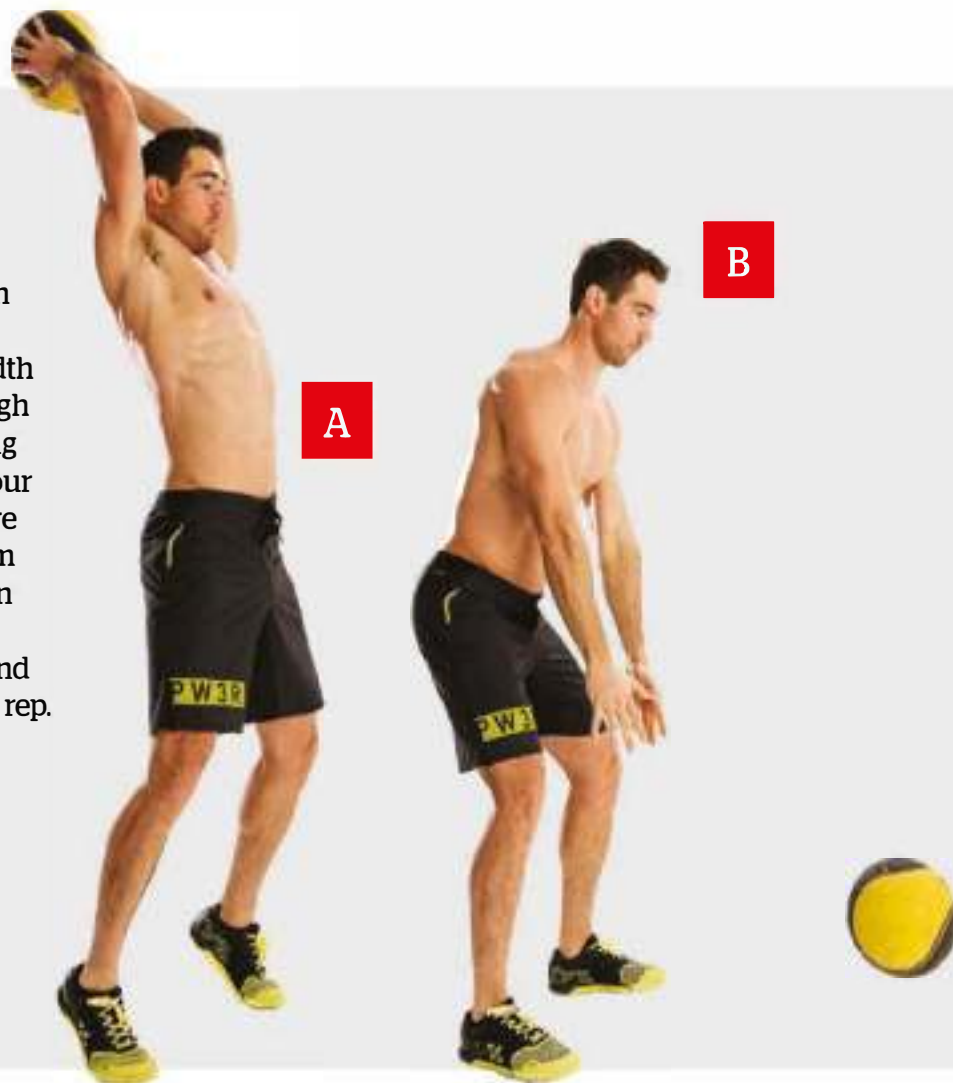
SETS 6
TIME 30 sec
REST 0 sec



3 MEDICINE BALL SLAM

Hold a medicine ball in two hands and stand with feet shoulder-width apart. Raise the ball high above your head, rising up on to the balls of your feet. Contract your core as you powerfully slam the ball into the floor in front of you. Catch the ball as it bounces up and continue into the next rep.

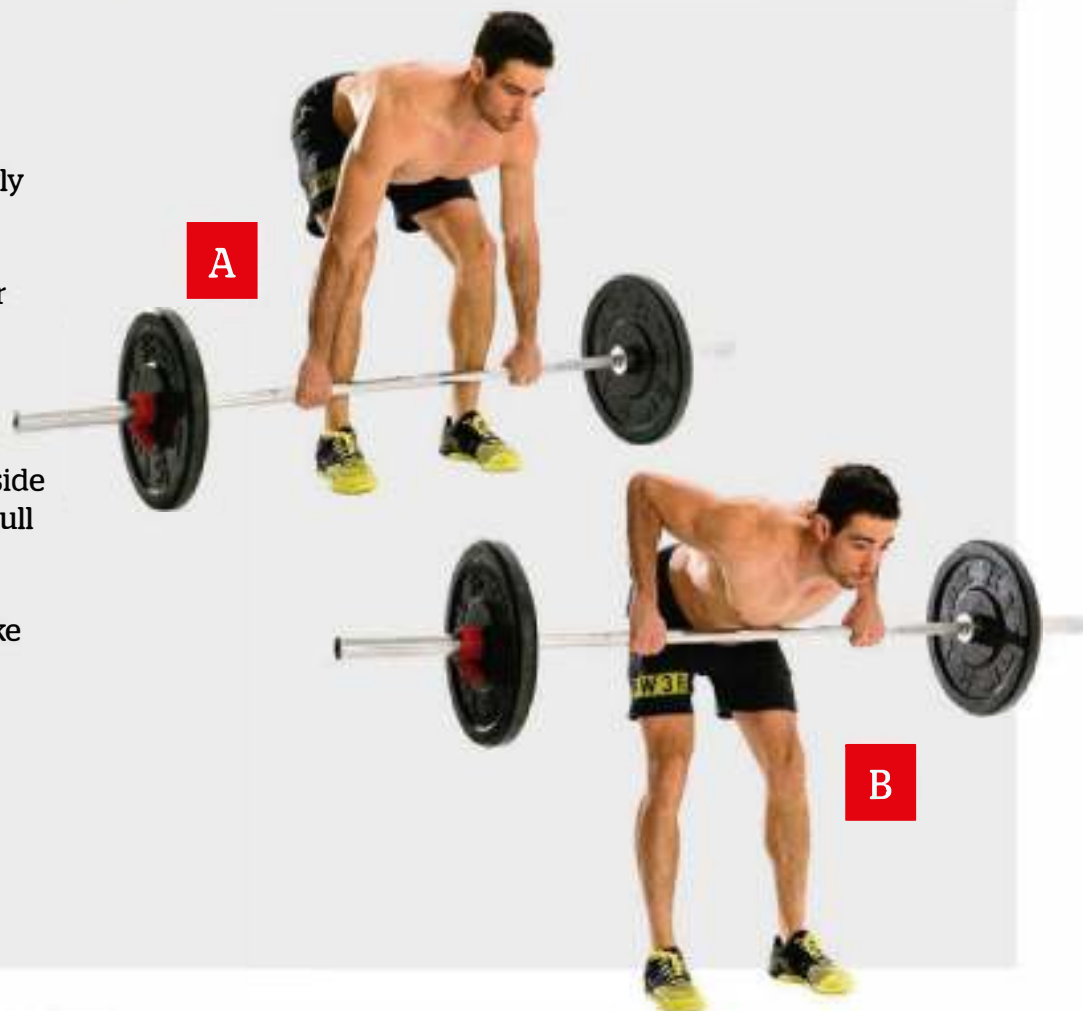
SETS 6
TIME 30 sec
REST 0 sec



4 PENDLAY POWER ROW

Bend your knees slightly and hinge forwards from the hips, keeping your back flat and your shoulder blades back throughout. With the bar starting on the floor, grab it with an overhand grip just outside your legs, powerfully pull the weight up to your lower sternum, then lower it to the floor. Take a breath and repeat.

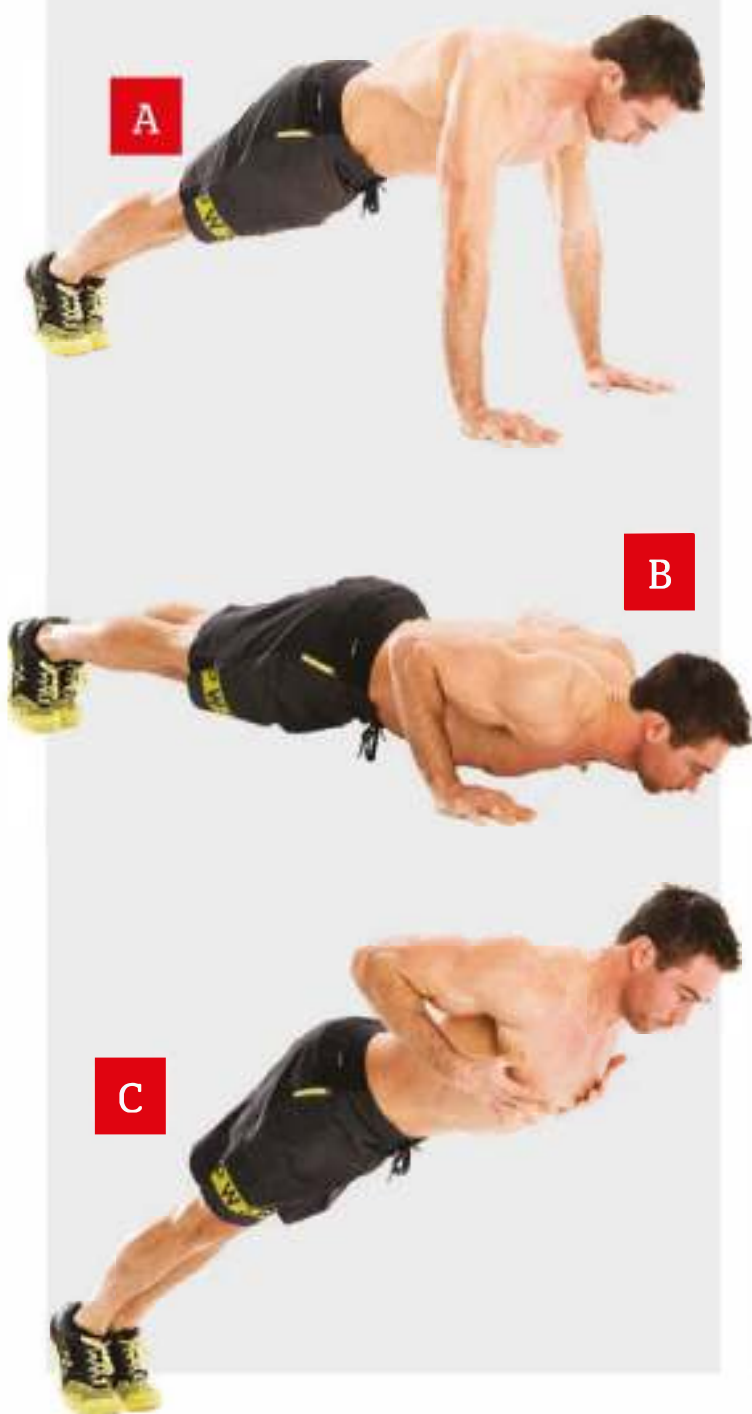
SETS 6
TIME 30 sec
REST 0 sec



5 GORILLA PRESS-UP

Start in a press-up position. Slowly lower to the ground, then explode up as fast as possible and bring your hands off the floor to slap them against your chest. Put your hands back out to land and continue into the next rep.

SETS 6
TIME 30 sec
REST 0 sec



6 PLATE CARRY

Hold a heavy weight plate to your chest. Keep your core strong and body upright, and walk forwards. Walk in figures of eight if space is tight.

SETS 6
TIME 30 sec
REST 3 min



Big arms workout

Arm yourself with the essential plan to grow sleeve-busting biceps and triceps in four workouts



The coach

Adam Gethin is founder of Creating Physiques (resultsbycp.com), an online personal training company specialising in body transformations.

Winning the arms race isn't as simple as hammering curls until your limbs turn to jelly - but it's not vastly more complicated.

"The key to growing any muscle is to make it stronger and make it work harder," says Gethin, the man behind this plan.

Beating your biceps up with curls might give your arms a good pump but they won't keep growing in the long term. Instead, a full body

workout with an emphasis on your biceps and triceps will make the difference.

"These workouts are designed to hit your body from every angle to maximise growth all over," says Gethin. "Together, they will stimulate the major anabolic hormones including testosterone, growth hormone and insulin-like growth factor 1, which are vital for maximal arm growth."

"Endless curls might give your arms a good pump, but a full body workout with an emphasis on your biceps and triceps will make the difference"

1 RACK PULL

Set the safety bars just above knee height on a squat rack. With the barbell resting on the bars, bend your knees and grasp it with a shoulder-width grip, retracting your shoulder blades to keep your back flat. Brace your core, press down through your heels and drive your hips forwards to stand and raise the bar. Lower the bar to touch the safety bars.

SETS 4
REPS 6
TEMPO 4010
REST 90 sec



2 PULL-UP

Grasp a bar with an overhand grip so your palms are facing away from you and your hands are shoulder-width apart. Contract your upper back muscles to help pull your sternum towards the bar, then lower under control.

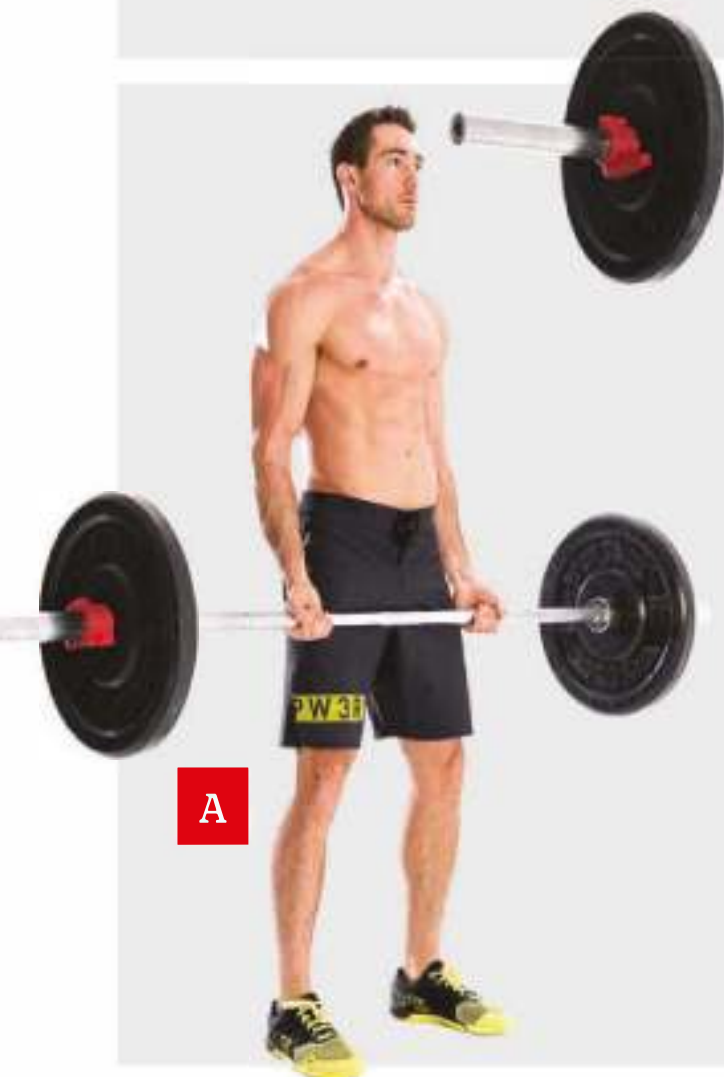
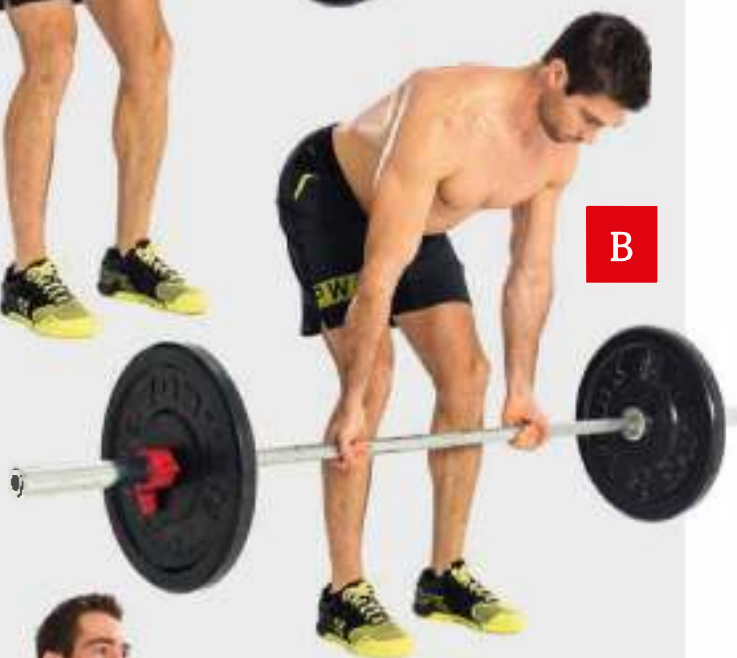
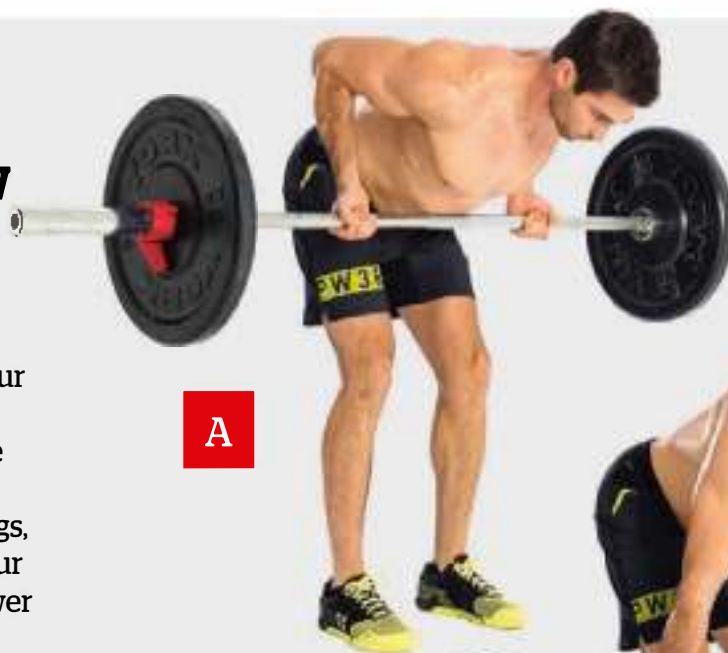
SETS 4
REPS 10
TEMPO 4010
REST 90 sec



3 BENT-OVER UNDERHAND BARBELL ROW

Bend your knees slightly and hinge forwards from the hips, keeping your back slightly concave and your shoulder blades back throughout. Holding the bar with an underhand grip just outside your legs, pull the weight up to your lower sternum, then lower it slowly.

SETS **4**
REPS **10**
TEMPO **4010**
REST **90 sec**



4 BARBELL BICEPS CURL

Hold a barbell with your hands shoulder-width apart and your palms facing forwards. Keeping your elbows close to your sides, and without leaning back, curl the bar up to your chest. Squeeze your biceps hard, then lower the bar.

SETS **3**
REPS **10**
TEMPO **4010**
REST **90 sec**

5 ZOTTMAN CURL

Hold dumbbells by your side with your palms facing forwards. Keeping your elbows close to your sides, curl the weights up to your chest. Rotate the weights so your palms face forwards again and slowly lower. Rotate the weights at the bottom and repeat.

SETS **3**

REPS **12**

TEMPO **4010**

REST **90 sec**



6 INCLINE DUMBBELL BICEPS CURL

Lie on a bench set at a 45° angle holding a dumbbell in each hand with your arms straight down by your sides and your palms facing forwards. Curl the weights up to shoulder height. Squeeze your biceps hard, then lower the weights slowly.

SETS **3**

REPS **12**

TEMPO **4010**

REST **90 sec**

1A INCLINE DUMBBELL PRESS

Lie on a bench set at a 45° angle, holding dumbbells beside your chest. Drive your feet into the floor and press the weights straight overhead before lowering slowly.

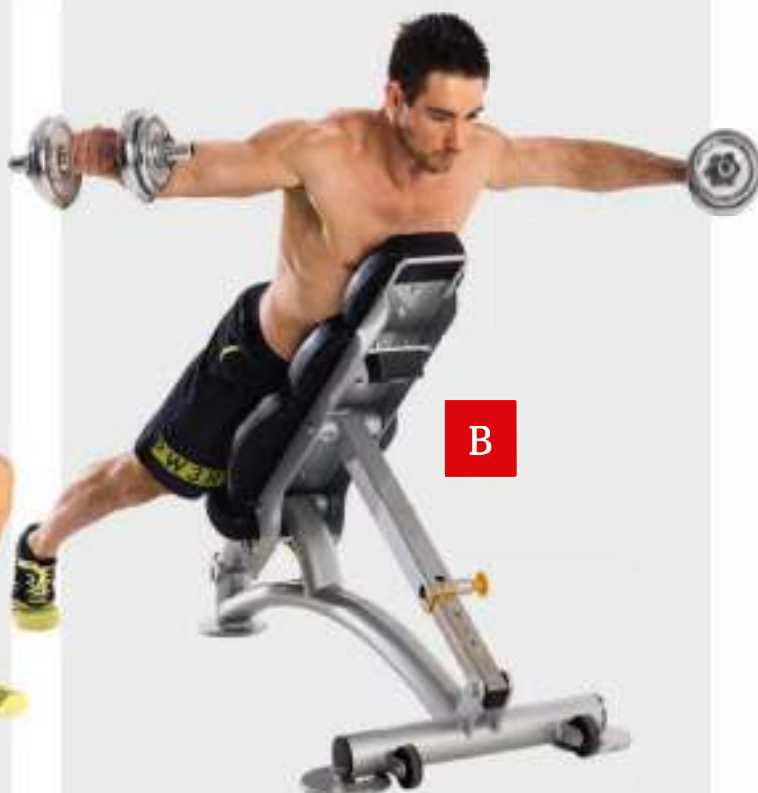
SETS **4**
REPS **15**
TEMPO **4010**
REST **0 sec**



1B CHEST SUPPORTED REVERSE FLYE

Lie chest down on a bench set at a 45° angle, holding light dumbbells with straight arms, palms facing each other. Squeeze your upper back muscles together and raise your arms out to the sides until they're parallel with the floor, then lower to the start.

SETS **4**
REPS **15**
TEMPO **4010**
REST **90 sec**



2A DIAMOND PRESS-UP

Perform a standard press-up but with the tips of your thumbs and forefingers touching to make a diamond. Lower your chest all the way until it touches your hands, then press back up until your arms are straight. This ensures a full range of motion to work your pecs and triceps.

SETS 4
REPS 15
TEMPO 4010
REST 0 sec



2B BARBELL BICEPS CURL

Hold a barbell with your hands shoulder-width apart and your palms facing forwards. Keeping your elbows close to your sides, and without leaning back, curl the bar up to your chest. Squeeze your biceps hard, then lower the bar.

SETS 4
REPS 15
TEMPO 4010
REST 90 sec



A

B



C

D

3A ZOTTMAN CURL

Hold dumbbells by your side with your palms facing forwards. Keeping your elbows close to your sides, curl the weights up to your chest. Rotate the weights so your palms face forwards again and slowly lower. Rotate the weights at the bottom and repeat.

SETS 4
REPS 15
TEMPO 4010
REST 0sec

3B DUMBBELL TRICEPS EXTENSION

Stand holding dumbbells above your head with your upper arms close to your ears. Keeping your upper arms static, bend at the elbows to lower the weights behind your head, then flex your triceps to raise the weights straight up.

SETS 4
REPS 15
TEMPO 4010
REST 0sec



A

B

Nutrition

Fuel your training and enhance your muscle-building and fat-loss efforts with these straightforward tips

You probably know that you can't achieve the results you want, no matter how hard you train, if you live on a diet of ice cream and chips. But in case you're not sure what you should be eating, here's some easy-to-follow advice to help you maximise the effect of your workouts.



Nutrition **101**



Follow these simple guidelines that will help you eat better, train harder, store less body fat and build more muscle...

1 EAT MORE VEG THAN FRUIT

All fruits and veg contain health-enhancing nutrients. But while the five-a-day mantra is good at encouraging people to eat more fresh produce in general, if you want to get the most out of your training and support your fat-burning and muscle-building efforts, you need to be a lot more specific about your intake.

For a start, try to have as much veg as possible while cutting back on fruit. Fruit is high in fructose, a type of sugar that plays havoc with blood sugar levels, making you far more likely to store fat.

Vegetables, on the other hand, contain no fructose but are just as nutrient dense, making them a far better dietary staple. Green vegetables in particular are a great choice - they're an excellent source of slow-release carbs, unlike starchy root vegetables such as potatoes, which can also negatively affect your blood sugar levels.

Eat as many servings of green vegetables as possible each day and limit your fruit intake to one to two servings, ideally from low-sugar sources such as blueberries or strawberries.

2 STICK TO WHOLEFOODS

Nothing will hamper your progress more than over-indulging in processed foods. Regularly eating the refined carbs and sugars that form the basis of most processed snacks, baked goods and fast foods will sap your energy levels and cause fat-storing blood sugar spikes, making it far harder to lose weight or perform at an optimum level.

What makes these foods even worse is that they typically contain high levels of man-made trans fats, which will make you feel very lethargic and boost your levels of bad LDL cholesterol.

For a healthier alternative, swap processed foods for more naturally indulgent wholefood alternatives. For example, you can trade crisps for nuts, chocolate spread for peanut or almond butter, and breakfast cereal for porridge oats - all of which have great additional nutritional benefits.

3 UP YOUR PROTEIN

Protein plays a crucial role in building muscle, but it's easy to underestimate just how much you need to maximise its benefits. Estimates vary from 1-4g per kilo of bodyweight per day, but most nutritionists agree that 2g is the minimum.

If you want to keep things simple, aim to eat a 20-25g serving of protein - good sources of which include meat, fish, dairy and eggs - with every meal, including breakfast, adding an extra post-workout serving on training days.

Sooner or later, someone will probably raise an eyebrow at the amount of protein you're ingesting. They may even tell you it's bad for your health. But, the only studies that have suggested protein can cause kidney problems were carried out on people with pre-existing kidney problems.

In addition to aiding your muscle-building efforts, protein-rich foods also tend to be very filling, so you avoid the urge to pig out between meals.

4 CHOOSE THE RIGHT FATS

“Eating fatty foods makes you fat” may sound like a logical assumption, but it’s a bit more complicated than that.

It is true that at nine calories per gram, fat is more calorific than carbohydrate or protein – which contain four each – but the reality is certain fats are a crucial part of your diet. The mono- and polyunsaturated fats that occur naturally in foods such as oily fish, nuts, seeds, olives and coconut oil, for example, play key roles in boosting metabolism, improving hormone synthesis and increasing good HDL cholesterol.

Don’t be fooled by “low-fat” options either. Most have been highly processed to remove the fat, and tend to be packed with salt and sugar to enhance their flavour. Instead, focus your energies on avoiding processed junk foods, high in unhealthy man-made trans fats, and enjoy daily servings of healthy, naturally occurring fat sources.

5 LOSE THE BOOZE

It may sound obvious, but cutting your alcohol intake will have a huge impact on your attempts to build fat and burn muscle.

As well as providing hundreds of nutritionally empty calories, regular boozing stimulates your appetite when you’re at your weakest – would you find a doner kebab so appealing otherwise? You’re also far less likely to want to train or eat healthily – even with a little hangover.

If you must indulge, opt for red wine, which has been found to reduce the risk of cardiovascular disease and enhance muscle endurance thanks to its resveratrol content. Stick to two glasses, after which the negatives outweigh the positives.

6 DON’T JUST COUNT CALORIES

It’s easy to fall into the trap of focusing on the quantity of calories you’re consuming, especially if you’re trying to lose weight. But the quality of the food you’re eating is far more important, because calories alone don’t provide a reliable indication of the effect a food can have on your metabolism.

For example, drinking a can of blood sugar-spiking fizzy pop is far more damaging to your fat-loss efforts than eating two protein-rich poached eggs, even though both contain a similar number of calories.

It’s also easy to use calorie counting as an excuse to justify poor food choices – a “healthy option” packet of crisps may contain fewer than 100 calories, but it’s likely to be full of trans-fats and other nasties.

Instead of getting hung up on how many calories every item of food contains, concentrate on eating plenty of wholefoods, vegetables, meats and fish.

“Don’t be fooled by ‘low-fat’ options. Most have been highly processed to remove the fat, and tend to be packed with salt and sugar”

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